Mission & Charter

Tech Awareness Association

Mission & Charter

By Ronit Sharma, Tanay Mangal, Nathan Anwin, Suhaas Goluguri, Ekansh Jain

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What We're About

Tech Awareness Association teaches people in Worcester County how to fix their devices, reduce e-waste, and understand the technology they use every day. We run hands-on workshops, help seniors with tech problems, and collect old electronics to keep them out of landfills. Our goal is simple: make technology more accessible, repairable, and sustainable for everyone in our community.

Our Vision

We want to create a community where people have the skills and confidence to repair their own devices instead of throwing them away. Technology shouldn't be a mystery or something you replace the moment it breaks, it should be something anyone can understand, fix, and keep using for years.

What We Believe In

Learning by Doing
The best way to understand technology is to take it apart and put it back together. We teach through hands-on experience, not lectures.

Fighting E-Waste
Electronic waste is destroying our environment. We're committed to keeping devices out of landfills by teaching repair skills and running responsible recycling programs.

Helping Our Community
Everyone deserves access to technology and the knowledge to use it. We focus on helping seniors, families, and anyone who needs tech support but doesn't know where to turn.

Student-Led Change
Young people can make a real impact. We're proof that high school students can run meaningful community programs that actually help people.

Working Together
We partner with the library, senior centers, and local organizations because we can do more together than alone.

What We Do

Library Workshops

We run monthly sessions at the Shrewsbury Public Library where people learn actual repair skills. Participants work on donated phones and laptops, learning how to replace batteries, fix screens, and troubleshoot common problems using iFixit guides. We also host "tear-down" sessions where people safely take apart devices just to see how they work and understand what's inside.

For seniors and families who struggle with everyday tech, we offer one-on-one help with anything from setting up a new phone to understanding apps to staying safe online.

E-Waste Drive

Once a year, we collect old electronics from across Shrewsbury. This keeps harmful materials out of landfills and gives us devices to learn on. During the drive, we bring in speakers to talk about the environmental impact of e-waste and why fixing devices matters.

The electronics we collect either get used for teaching, sent to certified recyclers, or sold to raise money. Any funds we make go to environmental organizations that align with what we're trying to do.

Community Repair Events

We host events where people bring their broken devices and we help them fix it together. It's not just us doing the repair, we teach them how to do it themselves so they can fix things in the future.

We also visit the Southgate Senior Center regularly to help with tech issues, answer questions, and provide patient support for people who didn't grow up with smartphones and computers.

Other Cool Stuff We Do

We run repair escape rooms where teams compete to fix device components and solve tech problems for prizes. We also use 3D printers with recycled filament to make phone cases and accessories, teaching people about sustainable manufacturing and design in the process.

What We're Working Toward

Environmental Goals
Collect and properly recycle hundreds of pounds of e-waste each year. Teach hundreds of people why repair matters and how to make their devices last longer.

Education Goals
Give people real hands-on STEM experience outside of school. Build problem-solving skills and technical confidence. Show people that engineering and technology careers are possible paths.

Community Goals
Help 100+ people every year with their technology problems. Make tech accessible for seniors and people who get left behind by rapid digital change. Connect different generations through shared learning.

Who We Are & Who We Work With

Our Team

We're a group of high school students who know how to fix devices and want to share that knowledge. We've all volunteered before, we've all taken things apart to see how they work, and we all care about the environment and our community.

Our Partners

Shrewsbury Public Library hosts our workshops and connects us with people who need help.

Southgate Senior Center lets us provide regular tech support to their community.

iFixit provides repair guides and potentially tools to help us teach better.

Local recycling facilities handle the e-waste we collect responsibly.

How We Keep This Running

We fund ourselves through the e-waste drive by selling recyclable materials and repairable devices. We also sell 3D-printed phone cases and accessories made from donated recycled filament. Eventually we'll apply for grants and look for local business sponsors.

We're building up a collection of donated devices and tools for teaching. As we grow, we want to run workshops more often, partner with more community spaces, and maybe even help other towns start their own programs.

Why This Matters

Every phone in a landfill releases toxic chemicals. Every senior who can't use their smartphone loses connection to family. Every person who throws away a repairable laptop wastes money and materials.

We're teaching people to fix things, understand technology, and take care of the environment, all at the same time. That's how we're making Shrewsbury better, one repair at a time.

Founded 2025 | Shrewsbury, MA

Roles

Roles

1. Executive Director (Ronit)

Owns: vision, decisions, accountability
Does:

- Sets priorities and long-term direction
- Leads meetings and keeps everyone aligned
- Represents the organization externally
- Resolves conflicts and makes final calls

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2. Programs & Education Lead(Tanay)

Owns: everything that happens at events
Combines: Program Director + Repair Mentor + Training
Does:

- Plans workshops and repair events
- Trains members on repair + teaching style
- Ensures “teach, don’t fix-for” standard
- Maintains workshop structure and quality

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3. Operations & Logistics Lead (Nathan)

Owns: tools, devices, safety, readiness
Combines: Operations + Intake + Safety
Does:

- Manages tools, devices, storage
- Handles device intake & diagnostics

- Enforces safety procedures
- Prepares kits for every event

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4. Outreach & Community Lead (Suhaas and Ekansh)

Owns: people & partnerships
Combines: Outreach + Volunteer + Senior Support + Marketing
Does:

- Communicates with library & senior center
- Recruits and schedules volunteers
- Manages email, flyers, and announcements
- Ensures accessibility & community needs are met

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5. Finance & Impact Lead (Suhaas and Ekansh)

Owns: money + metrics
Combines: Finance + Fundraising + Impact Tracking
Does:

- Tracks income and expenses
- Manages fundraising efforts
- Records impact metrics (people helped, e-waste)
- Prepares data for grants and sponsors

Feb Tasks By Person

Feb Tasks By Person

Everyone — Library Workshops

- Weeks 4 and 5 are coming up (Feb 22 and March 1) — confirm all materials, slides, and tools are ready
- Tanay leads educational slides; Nathan handles tool/device prep; Suhaas/Ekansh manage outreach and photos; Ronit oversees execution
- Log attendance and impact data after each session (Suhaas tracks)
- Post a workshop recap on Instagram within 2 days of each session (Ekansh)
- Begin preparing Week 6 materials (March 8)

Suhaas + Ekansh — Senior Center

- Finalize the 3 senior lesson plans (Setting Up Apps, Video Calling, Managing Storage) with post-session feedback forms
- Complete the "How to Avoid Scams" slideshow with large text, patient tone, and clear action steps
- Coordinate with Southgate Senior Center to lock in a regular visit schedule and confirm dates
- Prep accessibility tools and materials at least one week before the first visit
- After the visit, post a senior-support impact story on Instagram within 2 days

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Nathan + Ekansh — Future Plans: Elementary School Talks

- Research and outline what an elementary/middle school seminar program would look like (topics: basic tech awareness, e-waste, responsible device use)
- Identify 2–3 target schools in Shrewsbury to pitch to
- Draft an outreach email template for contacting school administrators or tech coordinators
- Create a simple one-pager summarizing what TAA would offer (age-appropriate, short session format)
- Bring a proposal to the full team for review before any outreach is sent

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Ronit + Tanay — E-Waste Drive

- Email Library for E-waste Drive dates
- Install permanent bin at library
- Draft logistics for each site: staffing, bins, signage, and pickup coordination

- Identify and contact at least one certified e-waste recycling facility to handle collected materials
- Create promotional content (flyers, Instagram posts) advertising the drive with dates and drop-off locations
- Develop a simple intake tracking sheet to log what gets collected (device type, weight estimate, condition)

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iFixit

Subject: Partnership Inquiry: High School Repair Club Seeking Tool Kits & Educational Materials

Dear iFixit Education Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-founded organization in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts dedicated to teaching device repair, reducing e-waste, and empowering our community through hands-on technology education. I'm reaching out because iFixit's mission aligns perfectly with what we're building. We've been inspired by your support of student-led repair initiatives like The IT Club, and we believe a partnership could significantly expand our impact.

Tech Awareness Association runs weekly hands-on repair workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library, teaching community members how to replace batteries and screens on phones, maintain and upgrade laptops, diagnose common device issues, and make informed repair-vs-replace decisions. We also provide regular tech support at Southgate Senior Center and organize an annual e-waste drive to keep electronics out of landfills. Our impact goals are to teach 100+ community members repair skills annually, divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills, and provide free tech education to underserved populations, especially seniors.

We currently use iFixit guides extensively in our workshops, and they've been invaluable for teaching repair fundamentals. To expand our programming, we're seeking support in three key areas: professional-quality tool kits that participants can use during workshops (we'd be thrilled to showcase iFixit tools and teach proper usage), educational parts such as spare screens, batteries, and charging ports for teaching demonstrations (even damaged or obsolete components would be valuable for hands-on learning), and retired devices or old electronics that can serve as practice units for students learning repair techniques.

We're a group of five high school students with hands-on repair experience through FRC robotics, personal projects, and self-taught skills. We've formalized our organization with clear roles, partnerships with local institutions, and a commitment to sustainable growth. Would you be open to a brief conversation about iFixit's education partnership program and how we might collaborate to make repair accessible in Worcester County?

Thank you for considering our request. We're excited about the possibility of joining the iFixit education community and amplifying the right-to-repair movement at the grassroots level.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com | rshar272k@gmail.com | tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) 206-7007

iFixit Sponsership Email

Subject: Partnership Inquiry: High School Repair Club Seeking Tool Kits & Educational Materials

Dear iFixit Educational Team,

My name is Nathan Anwin, and we are the Tech Awareness Association, a student led organization based in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts. Our mission is to help people in Worcester County repair their devices, reduce e-waste, and better understand the technology that they use on a daily basis. We've been inspired by your support of student-led repair initiatives like The IT Club, and we believe a partnership could significantly expand our impact.

Through weekly workshops of 8 people from 2PM - 3PM at the Shrewsbury Public Library, we teach community members the inner workings of our phones and laptops through hands-on repair and lesson plans covering each of the parts of our devices. We also provide one to one technology support for seniors, and are planning on hosting community repair events, and e-waste drives that keep devices out of landfills while providing equipment for learning when it gets warmer here in Massachusetts. Beyond repairs, our main goals are to promote confidence, and make technology more accessible to everybody in our community.

Looking ahead, we plan to expand our workshops to additional community spaces, increase the number we serve each workshop, and build a stronger inventory of devices and tools so our participants can better practice real repairs. We also are planning on developing structured repair training sessions for younger students interested in STEM careers and potentially help other towns start similar programs to ours.

Because of iFixit's leadership in repair education and our firsthand experience in utilizing your tools and free schematics/guides, we would be incredibly grateful for your support. Specifically, we are seeking a donation of six repair toolkits to use during our workshops so more participants can safely learn hands-on repair skills. If possible, we would also appreciate any donated laptops or devices that could be used for practice and training. These resources would directly increase the number of people we can teach and the impact we make.

We deeply admire iFixit's commitment to the right to repair movement and the belief that technology should be understandable, fixable, and sustainable. The Tech Awareness Association and the work that we do was built upon those same principles, and we would be beyond honored to partner with your organization to bring repair education to more people in our community.

Thank you for your consideration. We deeply appreciate the possibility of joining the iFixit education community, and of amplifying the right to repair movement.

iFixit EDU Meeting Prep

PAGE 1 | TECH AWARENESS ASSOCIATION — iFixit EDU Meeting Prep

Meeting with Marty Rippens, Director of Education Services | Teach. Repair. Sustain.

WHO WE ARE

5 High Schoolers | Shrewsbury, MA | Founded 2025

- **Organization:** student-led, community-focused, 100% free programming
- **Primary venue:** Shrewsbury Public Library, confirmed monthly space
- **Senior partner:** Southgate Senior Center, regular tech-support visits
- **Curriculum:** 12-week program, Sundays 2–3PM, launched Feb 1, 2026, 4 workshops completed
- **Format:** 30 min lesson + 25 min hands-on + 5 min Q&A every session
- **Philosophy:** "Teach, don't fix-for", build lifetime skills, not dependency
- **Team roles:** Director, Programs Lead, Ops Lead, Outreach Lead, Finance Lead
- **Year-1 goals:** 100+ people served, 12 full workshops, annual e-waste drive
- **Already have:** toolkits, a few devices, library space, curriculum drafted

WHAT WE'RE ASKING FOR

Be specific. Be confident. This is a reasonable ask.

- **Tool kits** — iFixit Pro Tech or equivalent for participant use at workshops
- **Curriculum/guide access** — educational versions we can adapt for seniors and beginners
- **Practice components** — batteries, screens, ports for demos (broken/obsolete is fine)
- **Donated/decommissioned devices** — phones/laptops for teardown & repair practice
- **Official partner status** — letter or designation we can cite in grant applications
- **Featured on iFixit EDU** — recognition as a student community partner on their site/social
- **Guidance & mentorship** — ask what other student programs do, what mistakes to avoid
- **Right to Repair resources** — advocacy materials we can share at workshops and events

THE TEAM —> Who We Are & What We Do

Name	Role	Owns	Day-to-Day
Ronit Sharma	**Executive Director**	Vision, decisions, external representation	Sets priorities, leads meetings, manages partnerships, represents TAA externally, resolves conflicts, makes final calls
Tanay Mangal	**Programs & Education Lead**	Everything that happens at events	Plans workshops, trains members on repair & teaching style, enforces "teach, don't fix-for"

			standard, maintains workshop structure and quality
Nathan Anwin	**Operations & Logistics Lead**	Tools, devices, safety, readiness	Manages tools & device inventory, handles device intake & diagnostics, enforces safety procedures, preps kits for every event
Suhaas Goluguri	**Outreach & Community Lead**	People, partnerships, marketing	Communicates with library & senior center, recruits volunteers, manages flyers & announcements, ensures community needs are met
Ekansh Jain	**Finance & Impact Lead**	Money, metrics, fundraising	Tracks income & expenses, manages fundraising & grant applications, records impact data (people helped, e-waste diverted), prepares sponsor reports

QUESTIONS TO ASK MARTY

Genuine curiosity is your best tool in this meeting

- What does your education partnership program look like for student-led orgs?
- Are there tool kits or guide packs specifically designed for community programs?
- Can we access iFixit EDU curriculum to adapt for seniors and total beginners?
- How do other student programs typically structure their relationship with iFixit?
- Are there decommissioned or surplus devices TAA could use for teardowns? (35) Can we have 35 devices?
- Could TAA be featured on iFixit's website or social media as a student partner?

KEY FACTS TO HAVE READY

Know these cold — don't look them up during the meeting

- **Workshops completed:** 4 sessions run since Feb 1, 2026 — program is live and active
- **Contact:** contact@techawarenessma.com | (617) 206-7007
- **Web/social:** techawarenessma.com | @techawarenessma
- **Team:** 5 members — Ronit, Tanay, Nathan, Suhaas, Ekansh
- **STEM background:** FRC Team 467 robotics, programming, electrical systems
- **iFixit usage:** guides are the backbone of our curriculum already
- **Topics span:** phone repair → laptops → seniors → scams → e-waste
- **iFixit EDU scale:** 32,000+ students, 102 universities supported globally
- **Outreach done:** Southgate, iFixit, planning e-waste

• What does iFixit need from us to formalize a partnership going forward? • Are there other student repair programs in MA we should be learning from? • What metrics or impact data matters most to iFixit when evaluating programs? • Is there a grant or sponsorship pathway through iFixit Foundation we qualify for?	• **Mission:** "Make technology accessible, repairable, and sustainable for everyone"

PAGE 2 | PERSUASION POINTS — Why iFixit Should Back TAA

Use these organically — don't recite them. Work them in as the conversation naturally opens up.

MISSION ALIGNMENT

Show you're not just fans — you're an extension of what they do

- iFixit's core mission is making repair knowledge free and accessible. TAA is the physical manifestation of that in a real community — we take their digital guides and make them hands-on experiences for people who would never find iFixit on their own
- Right to Repair is a values movement. TAA puts that movement in front of seniors and working families who are the most harmed by throwaway culture — demographics iFixit rarely reaches directly
- iFixit has backed The IT Club, which refurbishes computers for underrepresented students. TAA is a natural next step — repair education in real communities, not just device redistribution
- We teach the "why" of repair, not just the "how"— e-waste impact, planned obsolescence, financial savings. This is exactly the awareness content iFixit produces but

PROOF OF LEGITIMACY

We're not a club idea — we're already operational

- 3 workshops already completed at Shrewsbury Public Library since Feb 1 — real attendees, real sessions, real impact being tracked
- Southgate Senior Center partnership established — we have ongoing access to a population that desperately needs patient tech support
- Full 12-week curriculum drafted by subject area with specific learning outcomes, hands-on components, and supply lists for each session
- Formal roles, task trackers, shared Google Drive, budget planning, and impact tracking systems already set up and running
- Contacted 15+ potential sponsors and partners: Best Buy, SYFS, local law firms, CPAs, recyclers, MBI, TechSoup, iFixit Foundation — we are

WHAT iFixit GETS

This partnership benefits them too — say it directly

- Ground-level proof their educational content works for community audiences, not just university STEM students — seniors and families using iFixit guides is genuinely valuable data
- Brand visibility with community audiences they don't reach: public library attendees, senior center visitors, Shrewsbury families — a different demographic than their typical user
- Student ambassador presence on social media with real workshop photos, impact stories, and before/after repair documentation
- A replicable model — if TAA works, iFixit can point to it as proof that community repair programs are viable and help others replicate it elsewhere
- Logo on all materials, website, workshop flyers, grant applications, and press mentions — consistent

can’t always deliver in person
- Our "teach, don’t fix-for" philosophy mirrors iFixit’s belief that repair knowledge should be universal. We don’t do the repair for people — we empower them to do it themselves

actively building infrastructure
- FRC Team 467 and 190 background gives us real technical credibility — we know how to work with motors, sensors, code, and electronics under competition pressure
- Multiple emails to community stakeholders already sent and professional in tone — we operate like an organization, not a student club

co-branding with a growing organization
- Feedback loop on which guides work best for non-technical audiences and where gaps exist — student-observed curriculum insights
- Connection to library and senior center networks across Shrewsbury and Worcester County for future iFixit partnerships or events

IF THEY PUSH BACK — HANDLE IT CONFIDENTLY

These are real objections. Have an honest, grounded answer ready.

- **"You’re not a nonprofit yet."** → We’re exploring nonprofit formation with legal guidance. Our institutional anchors (public library + senior center) give us credibility and accountability now. We’re building properly, not rushing.
- **"How much have you actually done?"** → We’ve completed 3 workshops since Feb 1 with real community attendees. We’re not pitching a plan — we’re coming to you with a program already in motion.
- **"We get a lot of requests like this."** → We get that — most programs want tools and move on. We’re asking for a relationship. We’ll send monthly impact reports and want to be a program iFixit can actually learn from.

IMPROV TALKING POINTS — DROP THESE NATURALLY

Stat + story combos that hit harder than a pitch

- “We started because one of our friends had a cracked laptop screen. We ordered the part, used an iFixit guide, and saved him over $100. That’s the moment we realized most people don't help seniors, families, and anyone who needs tech support through workshops, one-on-one sessions, and community evet know this is possible.”
- “The average senior pays $150–$300 for repairs that often cost $15 in parts and 30 minutes with a guide. We’re eliminating that gap one workshop at a time.”
- “Millions of pounds of e-waste are generated every year. Most of it is fixable. We teach people to fix it before it becomes toxic landfill.”
- “We’re not just teaching repair — we’re changing how people think

- **"How do we know you'll stick with it?"** → We've spent months building infrastructure before running a single session. That's unusual for a high school club. We have documented SOPs, leadership succession planning, and a handoff guide already drafted.
- **"What if your team graduates?"** → Already planning for it — our charter includes training two younger members per role and a leadership handoff guide. Sustainability is a core priority, not an afterthought.
- **"Is the library on board long-term?"** → We have recurring dates confirmed and are requesting an official partnership letter from the library for grant applications. The relationship is formal, not informal.

about technology. When someone fixes their own phone for the first time, they stop seeing tech as a black box."

- "iFixit guides are already the backbone of what we teach. A partnership doesn't change our curriculum — it just gives it the legitimacy and tools it deserves."
- "Seniors are the most targeted by tech scams and the least served by the repair industry. We're filling a gap that no one else in Shrewsbury is filling."
- "We're proof that the Right to Repair movement doesn't have to stay in policy debates. It can happen in a library on a Sunday afternoon in a town of 40,000 people."
- "Every student on our team is from FRC robotics. We're not guessing at repair — we've debugged motors, soldered circuits, and built systems under competition deadlines."

PAGE 3 | CURRICULUM, SUPPLIES & NEXT STEPS

Marty will want to understand what your program actually looks like. This page is your evidence.

12-WEEK WORKSHOP CURRICULUM — Show Marty This Directly

Each session: 25 min lesson + 30 min hands-on + 5 min Q&A | Sundays 2–3PM @ Shrewsbury Public Library

#	Topic	Awareness Component	Hands-On Activity
1	**Understanding the Technology General Awareness**	Busting myths: "I'll break it," internal components overview	Explore donated phones, identify real internal parts
2	**Repair or Replace?**	Financial & environmental cost of replacement, when to repair	Diagnose donated phones for storage/port/software issues
3	**Batteries & Lifespan**	Why batteries fail first, planned obsolescence explained	Safe battery removal + replacement on practice phones
4	**Phone Care & Prevention**	Heat, dust, charging habits that shorten device lifespan	Clean ports, manage storage & background apps, settings tune-up
5	**Laptop Awareness**	Why laptops feel intimidating, what actually fails inside	Safely open donated laptops, ID RAM/SSD/fan/battery
6	**Laptop Maintenance**	Dust, heat damage, why airflow and storage space matter	Clean fans, reseat RAM, run basic hardware diagnostics
7	**Community Repair Day**	"Teach, don't fix-for" — repair as empowerment philosophy	Fix-With-Us session — participants bring broken devices
8	**Tech & Seniors**	Why technology excludes seniors, patience as a design gap	1-on-1: apps, photos, video calling, accessibility settings
9	**Online Safety & Scams**	Emotional manipulation tactics, real-world scam examples	ID phishing emails/texts, practice safe responses
10	**E-Waste & Environment**	What happens to e-waste, toxic materials in landfills	"Tech Autopsy" teardown — identify recyclable/reusable parts
11	**Smarter Tech Consumer**	Evaluating upgrades, avoiding marketing hype, true cost	Analyze real devices + upgrade scenarios, repair-vs-replace
12	**Reflection & Next Steps**	How to keep repairing, community resources, what's next	Open help session, feedback surveys, group impact discussion

SUPPLIES WE ALREADY HAVE

Proof we're operational, not hypothetical

- **Precision screwdrivers:** Phillips, Pentalobe, Torx, flathead
- **Opening tools:** plastic spudgers, picks, suction cups
- **Fine-tip tweezers:** ESD-safe preferred
- **Magnetic trays:** for screw organization during teardowns
- **Cleaning supplies:** isopropyl alcohol 90%+, cotton swabs, lint-free wipes
- **Air blower:** manual or compressed air for fan/port cleaning
- **Donated devices:** phones and laptops for practice (working & non-working)
- **Library provides:** tables, projector/screen, outlets, WiFi, storage space
- **Safety items:** safety glasses, gloves, trash/recycling bags, labels

GAPS iFIXIT COULD FILL

Frame the ask around what we're missing, not what we want

- Professional-grade tool kits for participants to use hands-on (not just ours)
- Spare screens, batteries, and charging ports for teaching component-level repair
- More donated devices — especially a variety of models for different repair scenarios
- iFixit-branded materials for credibility with seniors and library audiences
- Curriculum guides adapted for beginners / non-technical users
- Access to iFixit EDU platform features for structured lesson planning
- Official partnership letter for use in Best Buy, MBI, and Hanover grant applications
- Right to Repair advocacy flyers or materials to distribute at events

NEXT STEPS — END OF MEETING

Leave with a clear action, not a vague "let's stay in touch"

- **Ask:** "What is the concrete next step from your side?"
- **Ask:** "Can we follow up with a formal one-pager or proposal?"
- **Offer:** "We'll send you our curriculum doc and a summary of today's conversation."
- **Confirm:** the right email address to follow up with
- **Timeline:** send thank-you email within 24 hours, attach mission doc
- **Share:** send Marty a recap of the 3 workshops already run — attendance, what worked, what participants said
- **Long-term:** propose monthly impact report to iFixit — make them feel invested
- **If he says no:** ask what would need to be true for a partnership to work in 6 months

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TECH AWARENESS ASSOCIATION

Partnership Proposal • iFixit Education Program

WHO WE ARE

Tech Awareness Association is a student-founded, community-driven organization based in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts. Founded in 2025 by five high school students, we teach Worcester County residents how to repair their devices, reduce e-waste, and confidently understand the technology they use every day. All programming is completely free.

Our team brings hands-on technical experience from FRC Robotics Team 467, personal repair projects, and self-taught electronics skills. We operate with formal roles, documented systems, and a long-term sustainability plan.

4	2	12 Weeks	100+
Workshops Completed	Community Partners	Workshop Series Length	Annual Goal: People Serve

WHAT WE DO

Library Workshops

Weekly Sunday sessions at Shrewsbury Public Library (2–3PM). 12-week curriculum covering phone & laptop repair, e-waste awareness, online safety, and senior tech support. Format: 25-min lesson + 30-min hands-on + Q&A.

Senior Tech Support

Regular tech support visits to Southgate Senior Center. One-on-one help with apps, video calling, scam prevention, and accessibility settings. Patient, judgment-free support.

Annual E-Waste Drive

Community electronics collection event in Shrewsbury. Collected devices are used for teaching, sent to certified recyclers, or sold to fund environmental initiatives.

Community Repair Events

"Teach, don’t fix-for" community sessions where participants bring broken devices and learn to repair them alongside our team. Builds lifetime skills, not dependency.

WHO WE HELP

Seniors

Adults who didn’t grow up with smartphones—targeted by scams, excluded by complex interfaces, and underserved by the tech industry.

Families & Community Members

People paying $150–$300 for repairs that cost $15 in parts—we close that gap with hands-on knowledge.

Students & Future STEM Professionals

Young people who need real hands-on STEM experience outside the classroom and a path toward technical confidence.

WHAT WE’RE SEEKING FROM iFIXIT

Based on our meeting with Marty Rippens, Director of Education Services, we are formally requesting the following partnership support:

Repair Tool Kits	6 iFixit Pro Tech or equivalent toolkits for participant use during workshops. Currently, participants share a limited set of tools, which restricts hands-on learning. These kits would let every participant work simultaneously.

Practice Devices	Donated or decommissioned phones and laptops for teardown and repair practice. Broken or obsolete devices are ideal. We currently use a small inventory of community-donated devices, but more variety would let us teach a broader range of repairs.
Educational Components	Spare screens, batteries, and charging ports for demonstration purposes. Even damaged or obsolete components are valuable for teaching participants what to look for and how repairs work at the component level.
Official Partner Status	A letter or designation confirming our relationship with iFixit EDU, which we can cite in grant applications to Best Buy, Hanover Foundation, and MBI. This significantly strengthens our credibility with funders.

WHY THIS PARTNERSHIP MAKES SENSE

iFixit guides are already the backbone of our curriculum. Every week, participants follow iFixit repair guides to replace batteries and troubleshoot phones and laptops. A formal partnership doesn't change what we teach—it gives it the tools and credibility it deserves.

We bring iFixit's digital guides to life in a physical community. We reach seniors, working families, and library visitors who would never find iFixit on their own. Every workshop is a demonstration that the Right to Repair movement works at the grassroots level—in a library, on a Sunday afternoon, in a town of 40,000 people.

CONTACT

Ronit Sharma, Executive Director
contact@techawarenessma.com | (617) 206-7007
www.techawarenessma.com | @techawarenessma

COMMUNITY PARTNERS

Shrewsbury Public Library | Southgate Senior Center
609 Main Street, Shrewsbury, MA 01545
Founded 2025 | Worcester County, Massachusetts

E-Waste Drive

E-Waste Drive

Wow, this is so locked in.

Senior Center

Senior Center

Wow, this is so not accurate.

Elementary School Plans

Elementary School Plans

Wow, this is so locked in.

Library Plans

Library

The Tech Awareness and Repair Program is going to be a 12 week long program, one hour per week and the goal of this program is to teach the community skills like technological awareness, digital literacy, and hands-on repair in a manner such that everyone can learn how to use technology effectively. Everyone can join and we want people who have limited knowledge about technology as it will allow us to give more knowledge to those who would most benefit from it.

The way that each session would work is that the first quarter of time is a lesson about the topic of the week, ranging from the basics of electronics to prevention methods and then afterwards, there is a hands-on section. In this hands-on section, people are doing the action or steps that we demonstrated, such as changing batteries.

Another one of our focuses is to emphasize sustainability and make sure that everyone has the basic knowledge about e-waste recycling, and the environmental benefits of learning how to repair technology instead of replace it. They will be more well informed about the technologies they have access to and would be more capable of being able to make decisions about repair, replacement, and safe technology use.

We don’t want people to waste technology and depend on organizations that overcharge people for repairs but rather build a generation of people who have knowledge about all sorts of technology and are able to pass it down. These are low-risk activities that focus on simple, easy to understand repairs which aid in the process of making sure everyone is aware about the various aspects of technology.

Week 1: General Awareness

Week 1: General Awareness

- Start off with a question: “Raise your hand if you’ve ever said, ‘It’s broken,’ without actually knowing what was wrong.”, **“What do you think is the most common reason people replace their phones?”**
-

Application

Application

Outline Of Program

Program Structure (Applies to Every Week)
Session length: 1 hour per week
Weekly format:
25 minutes: Awareness & education
30 minutes: Hands-on activity and guided tech help
5 minutes: Q&A and wrap-up

Weekly Schedule & Topics
(02-01-26)Week 1 – Understanding the Technologyhttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness/

- Awareness Component: Addressing the common myths behind technology such as “I’ll break it” or “It’s too hard,” and teaching the basic components that most electronic devices have.
- Hands-On Component: Exploring non-working donated phones and identifying internal parts.
- Outcome: Participants feel safer and more confident interacting with technology.

(02-08-26)Week 2 – Decisions Between Repairing or Replacinghttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-2/

- Awareness Component: Understanding the financial savings of repairing versus replacing devices, the environmental impact of discarding electronics, and when replacement is actually necessary.
- Hands-On Component: Diagnosing donated phones to determine which issues require parts and which do not (storage, settings, charging ports).
- Outcome: Participants learn how to make informed decisions before spending money.

(02-15-26)Week 3 – Batteries & Device Lifespanhttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-3/

- Awareness Component: Why batteries fail first, a simple explanation of planned obsolescence, and how to tell battery issues apart from software problems.
- Hands-On Component: Safe battery removal, battery replacement on practice phones, and battery health checks.
- Outcome: Participants learn the most common and useful phone repair skill.

(02-22-26)Week 4 – Phone Care & Preventative Maintenancehttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-4/

- Awareness Component: How poor maintenance shortens device lifespan, including the effects of heat, dust, and charging habits.
- Hands-On Component: Cleaning charging ports, checking storage and background apps, and adjusting settings to improve performance.
- Outcome: Participants learn how to prevent problems before they occur.

(03-08-26)Week 5 – Laptop Awareness: What Actually Breakshttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-5/

- Awareness Component: Why laptops often feel more intimidating than phones, common laptop failures, and which issues do not require professional repair.
- Hands-On Component: Safely opening donated laptops and identifying RAM, SSD, fan, and battery components.
- Outcome: Participants are no longer afraid to open and examine laptops.

(03-15-26)Week 6 – Laptop Maintenance & Simple Fixeshttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-6/

- Awareness Component: How dust and heat damage laptops and why airflow and storage space are important.
- Hands-On Component: Cleaning laptop fans, reseating RAM, and performing basic diagnostics (battery vs. storage vs. software).
- Outcome: Participants learn how to maintain laptops without spending money.

(03-22-26)Week 7 – Community Repair & Learning Togetherhttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-7/

- Awareness Component: Why community-based repair matters, the “teach, don’t fix-for” philosophy, and repair as empowerment rather than charity.
- Hands-On Component: A Fix-With-Us session where attendees bring devices and volunteers guide step-by-step troubleshooting.
- Outcome: Real community impact through shared learning and collaboration.

(04-12-26)Week 8 – Technology Accessibility & Seniorshttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-8/

- Awareness Component: Why technology often excludes seniors, the importance of confidence over speed, and patience as a design gap.
- Hands-On Component: One-on-one tech help focused on apps, photos, video calling, and accessibility settings.
- Outcome: Seniors gain independence and confidence using their devices.

(04-19-26)Week 9 – Online Safety & Scam Awarenesshttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-9/

- Awareness Component: Why scams target seniors and families, emotional manipulation tactics, and real-world examples.
- Hands-On Component: Identifying scam emails, texts, and pop-ups; practicing safe responses; reviewing a scam-prevention guide.
- Outcome: Participants learn how to protect themselves and others online.

(TBD)Week 10 – E-Waste & Environmental Impacthttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-10/

- Awareness Component: What happens to electronics after disposal, toxic materials in e-waste, and responsible recycling versus landfill dumping.
- Hands-On Component: Device teardown (“Tech Autopsy”) to identify reusable and recyclable parts.

- Outcome: Participants understand how repair helps reduce electronic waste.

(TBD)Week 11 – Becoming a Smarter Tech Consumerhttps://shrewsburyma.assabetinteractive.com/calendar/tech-awareness-11/

- Awareness Component: How to evaluate upgrades and tech marketing, when new features matter, and how to avoid unnecessary purchases.
- Hands-On Component: Analyzing real devices and upgrade scenarios and practicing repair-versus-replace decisions.
- Outcome: Participants become informed and critical technology users.

Week 12 – Reflection, Impact & Next Steps

- Awareness Component: How participants can continue repairing, helping others, and engaging with community repair resources.
- Hands-On Component: Open help session based on participant needs, feedback surveys, and group discussion.
- Outcome: The program concludes with confidence, reflection, and measurable community impact.

Supplies

This is the actual materials we are going to be using to repair and we possess most of these: Precision screwdriver sets (Phillips, Pentalobe, Torx, small flathead), Plastic spudgers and opening picks, Suction cups (for phone opening), Fine-tip tweezers (preferably ESD-safe), Small containers or magnetic trays for organizing screws, Manual air blower or compressed air, Isopropyl alcohol (90% or higher), Cotton swabs or lint-free wipes

For the actual devices, we plan to use donated smartphones (working or non-working), donated laptops (non-working is fine), donated tablets (optional), old batteries removed from donated devices (for awareness, not reuse) by asking companies for the tech they are able to throw out.

For safety some of the materials we want to use are safety glasses (only some lessons), disposable gloves (optional, for cleaning activities), paper towels, labels or masking tape (to label parts during tear-downs), trash bags, and recycling bags.

What we believe the library can provide: tables and chairs, projector/screen, power outlets and extension cords, internet access, printing for limited handouts, and space for storing donated devices during the program.

Interested

The reason why we are interested in running this program is because we have had first hand experience with observing people discard devices, even when they were perfectly usable. Additionally, there are thousands of people we know among ourselves personally that don’t know how to operate technology at a fundamental level for today's day and age and the mix of these two factors, it inspires us to teach people how to use and repair technology. For us, we have learned these skills by doing and we have found them to be very practical such as when the laptop screen of one of our friends' laptops cracked and instead of getting ripped off by a tech repair person, we ordered the part and saved an estimated 100 dollars. We want to make these experiences approachable and easy to understand as we believe the best outreach is the SPL. Additionally, we know that millions of pounds of e-waste gets wasted, and by teaching proper tech usage and repair habits, we are able to effectively combine our knowledge to serve the community.

Potential Challenges

We believe that there will be varying level technical experience within the audience and our goal for this is to advertise that the sessions are for beginners, ones who don’t know technology so that we are best able to support the people who truly need the help. Additionally, we are cautious about trusting people with devices and safety of that but we plan to get around this by asking companies for old technology they don;t need anymore and asking for sponsors to donate devices. Additionally, we don;t want them to be working with live electricity and we will be cautious for all safety concerns. Also, we are a bit worried that some participants are just signing up so that we would just fix their devices for them, not the main goal of the objective. Again, the solution for this comes down to the marketing where we teach them the skills, for which they can ask clarifying questions about specific devices afterwards such as in the five minutes for Questions we have allotted. Adding to this point, one final concern that we have is that we might have limited access to certain specialized parts for certain devices. Our solution to this is to make sure that we design our lessons around teaching them the core skills, ones that do not require highly specialized equipment, but if they have a specific question then we can guide them to where to buy specific parts and how to use them.

Slogan

We are the Tech Awareness Association. Our goal is to teach people how to understand their devices, fix what’s broken, and reduce e-waste. Technology shouldn’t be a mystery or something you throw away the moment it breaks.

#ewasteawareness #techrepair #techawareness #repairnotreplace #communitylearning

Poster

Poster

Learn to Repair, Understand, and Confidently Use Your Technology

Join Tech Awareness Association for hands-on workshops designed for everyone—no experience needed! Come to any session that interests you. No commitment required.

Who Should Attend?

- Anyone who feels intimidated by technology
- Seniors looking for patient, judgment-free tech support
- People tired of expensive repair bills
- Community members who want to reduce e-waste
- Anyone who wants to understand their devices better

What to Expect: Each 1-hour session includes:

- 25 minutes: Learn the "why" behind technology
- 30 minutes: Hands-on practice with real devices
- 5 minutes: Q&A and personalized help

We teach. We don't fix it for you. You'll learn skills you can use for life.

11-Week Workshop Series

Week 1: Understanding Your Technology *Stop being intimidated—see what's actually inside your devices*

Week 2: Repair or Replace? Making Smart Decisions *Learn when repair makes sense and when it doesn't*

Week 3: Batteries & Device Lifespan *The #1 reason devices "die"—and how to fix it yourself*

Week 4: Phone Care & Prevention *Simple habits that extend your device's life by years*

Week 5: Laptop Basics: What Actually Breaks *Open a laptop safely and identify key components*

Week 6: Laptop Maintenance & Simple Fixes *Keep your computer running smoothly without expensive repairs*

Week 7: Community Repair Day *Bring your broken device—we'll teach you how to fix it together*

Week 8: Technology for Seniors *One-on-one help with apps, photos, video calling, and accessibility*

Week 9: Online Safety & Avoiding Scams *Protect yourself from phishing, tech support scams, and fraud*

Week 10: E-Waste & Environmental Impact *See what's inside electronics and why repair matters for our planet*

Week 11: Becoming a Smarter Tech Consumer *Evaluate upgrades, avoid marketing hype, and make informed decisions*

📅 **SCHEDULE** [Day]: [Time] [Start Date] – [End Date]

📍 **LOCATION** Shrewsbury Public Library 609 Main Street, Shrewsbury, MA 01545

💰 **COST** FREE! All materials and tools provided.

📝 **REGISTRATION** Drop-in friendly! No registration required. Just show up to the sessions you're interested in.

About Tech Awareness Association We're a student-led organization teaching device repair, digital literacy, and e-waste reduction in Worcester County. Our mission: make technology accessible, repairable, and understandable for everyone.

Questions? 📧 techawarenessassociation@gmail.com 🌐 www.techawarenessma.com 📱 Follow us on Instagram: @techawarenessma

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"Technology shouldn't be a mystery or something you throw away the moment it breaks."

Reduce E-Waste • Save Money • Gain Confidence

Design Notes for Poster:

- Include images of: people repairing devices, seniors with smartphones, students teaching, e-waste recycling symbol
- Use large, readable fonts (especially important for seniors)
- Highlight "FREE" and "DROP-IN FRIENDLY" prominently
- QR code linking to techawarenessma.com

- Use your brand colors (once finalized with Tanay)
- Leave space to write in the specific day/time once confirmed

Community Interest Form

Community Interest Form

Help us understand how we can best serve you!

We're planning hands-on workshops, tech support sessions, and community repair events. This form helps us tailor our programs to what YOU need.

Basic Information

Name: _____

Email: _____

Phone Number (optional): _____

Zip Code: _____

Preferred Contact Method:

- Email
- Phone call
- Text message

About You

Age Range:

- Under 18
- 18-30
- 31-50
- 51-65
- 66+

How would you describe your comfort level with technology?

- Very comfortable - I can troubleshoot most issues myself
- Somewhat comfortable - I can do basic tasks but struggle with problems
- Not very comfortable - I need help with most tech tasks
- Not comfortable at all - Technology frustrates and intimidates me

What devices do you regularly use? (Check all that apply)

- Smartphone (iPhone)
- Smartphone (Android)
- Laptop (Windows)
- Laptop (Mac)
- Tablet (iPad)
- Tablet (Android)
- Desktop computer
- Other: _____

What Brings You Here?

Which best describes your interest? (Check all that apply)

- I want to learn how to repair my own devices
- I need help with a current tech problem
- I want to understand technology better
- I'm concerned about e-waste and want to learn sustainable practices
- I want patient, judgment-free tech support
- I'm interested in volunteering/helping others
- I want to save money on repair costs
- Other: _____

Do you currently have a device that needs repair or help?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure if it's fixable

If yes, please briefly describe the issue: _____

Workshop Topics of Interest

Which workshop topics interest you most? (Check all that apply)

- Understanding what's inside my devices
- Deciding when to repair vs. replace
- Battery replacement and device lifespan
- Preventing device problems before they happen

- Opening and maintaining laptops safely
- Bringing my broken device for hands-on help
- Apps, photos, and video calling (for seniors)
- Avoiding online scams and staying safe
- Understanding e-waste and environmental impact
- Making smart purchasing decisions
- All of the above
- Other: _____

What specific skills would you like to learn? (Open-ended)

Scheduling & Availability

How often would you attend workshops?

- Every week
- Every other week
- Once a month
- Only specific topics that interest me
- Just once to see if it's for me

E-Waste Donation

Do you have old electronics you'd like to donate for our workshops or e-waste drive?

- Yes - I have devices to donate
- Maybe - I need to check what I have
- No

If yes, what types? (Check all that apply)

- Old phones
- Old laptops/computers
- Tablets
- Cables/chargers
- Other electronics: _____

Additional Information

How did you hear about Tech Awareness Association?

- Shrewsbury Public Library
- Social media (Instagram/Facebook)
- Friend or family member
- Community flyer/poster
- Local news
- Website
- Other: _____

Is there anything else you'd like us to know? (Questions, concerns, specific needs, suggestions)

_____

_____

_____

_____

Stay Connected

Would you like to receive updates about upcoming workshops and events?

- Yes, send me email updates
- Yes, text me about events
- No, I'll check your website/social media

Follow us on Instagram: @techawarenessma
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com

Thank you for your interest!

We'll use this information to create workshops that truly serve our community's needs. We'll contact you soon with our finalized schedule.

Tech Awareness Association - Making technology accessible, repairable, and sustainable for everyone.

Device Repair Training Resources

Device Repair Training Resources

Self-Learning Resource Guide

Foundational Electronics & Safety

iFixit's Electronics Skills Course (Free)

- https://www.ifixit.com/Guide/Electronics+Skills/87309
- Comprehensive guide covering soldering, tool usage, and safety protocols
- *Tip: Start here before touching any devices. Practice on broken electronics first*

EEVblog's Soldering Tutorial (YouTube)

- Search: "EEVblog soldering tutorial for beginners"
- Industry-standard soldering technique tutorial
- *Tip: Watch multiple times and practice on scrap boards before real repairs*

iFixit Essential Toolkit Overview

- https://www.ifixit.com/Store/Tools
- Learn what each tool does and when to use it
- *Tip: Focus on precision screwdriver sets, spudgers, tweezers, and pry tools first*

SparkFun Electronics Basics

- https://learn.sparkfun.com/tutorials
- Free tutorials on circuits, components, and troubleshooting
- *Tip: Understanding basic circuits helps diagnose power and charging issues*

Device-Specific Repair Resources

Smartphones & Tablets

iFixit Repair Guides (Primary Resource)

- https://www.ifixit.com/Device/Phone
- https://www.ifixit.com/Device/Tablet
- Step-by-step photo guides with difficulty ratings
- *Tip: Read the entire guide before starting, note the difficulty level, and check comments for common issues*
- *Focus on: screen replacement, battery replacement, charging port repair (most common)*

JerryRigEverything (YouTube)

- Teardown videos showing internal device construction
- *Tip: Watch teardowns of devices you'll repair to understand their anatomy before opening them*

PBKreviews (YouTube)

- Detailed repair tutorials for specific phone models
- *Tip: Good for seeing real-time troubleshooting and problem-solving*

Laptops

iFixit Laptop Guides

- https://www.ifixit.com/Device/Laptop
- *Tip: Laptop repairs are often easier than phones - less glue, more screws*
- *Common repairs: RAM upgrades, SSD replacement, keyboard replacement, fan cleaning*

Louis Rossmann (YouTube - Advanced)

- Board-level repair and troubleshooting
- *Tip: Don't attempt this level initially, but watch to understand complex issues you might encounter*

Laptop Repair 101 (YouTube)

- Search for specific laptop models you're working on
- *Tip: Different manufacturers have wildly different disassembly procedures*

Software Troubleshooting Resources

Windows Support

Microsoft Support Site

- https://support.microsoft.com/
- Official documentation for Windows issues
- *Tip: Learn Safe Mode boot and System Restore first - they solve 50% of software issues*

Bleeping Computer Forums

- https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/forums/
- Community support for malware removal and complex issues
- *Tip: Read solved threads to learn diagnostic approaches*

Mac Support

Apple Support Site

- https://support.apple.com/
- *Tip: Apple's diagnostics are built-in - learn Recovery Mode and Disk Utility thoroughly*

MacRumors Forums

- https://forums.macrumors.com/
- Community troubleshooting for Mac-specific issues
- *Tip: MacOS errors often have specific solutions - search the exact error message*

Mobile OS Support

Android Central Forums

- https://forums.androidcentral.com/
- *Tip: Android issues vary by manufacturer - Samsung solutions differ from Pixel solutions*

Apple Support Communities

- https://discussions.apple.com/
- *Tip: iOS problems often relate to iCloud sync - check account status first*

Diagnostic & Troubleshooting Frameworks

Problem Identification Framework

1. Gather information (symptoms, timeline, recent changes)
2. Physical inspection (damage, wear, foreign objects)
3. Simple fixes first (restart, clean ports, updates)
4. Isolate the problem (software vs hardware)
5. Test systematically (document what works) *Tip: 80% of issues are solved in steps 1-3. Don't jump to hardware repair immediately*

Hardware Diagnostic Tools

Phone Check and Test (Android App)

- Tests all hardware sensors and components
- *Tip: Use this to verify what's actually broken before ordering parts*

Apple Diagnostics (Built-in for Mac)

- Hold D during startup for hardware test
- *Tip: Error codes tell you exactly which component failed*

Senior Tech Support Resources

AARP Tech Guide

- https://www.aarp.org/home-family/personal-technology/
- Simplified guides written for seniors
- *Tip: Use their language and analogies when teaching*

TechBoomers

- https://techboomers.com/
- Step-by-step tutorials for popular apps and services
- *Tip: Print these for seniors to follow at home*

Senior Planet

- https://seniorplanet.org/
- Free tech classes and resources for older adults
- *Tip: Their teaching methodology works well - patient, repetitive, no jargon*

Communication Tips for Senior Support:

- Never say "it's easy" or "just click here"
- Write everything down with screenshots
- Use analogies to physical objects (folders = filing cabinets)
- Repeat information without frustration
- Encourage questions at every step
- Follow up after appointments

Video Learning Channels

iFixit (YouTube)

- Official repair guides in video format
- *Tip: Combination of their written guides + videos gives best learning experience*

JerryRigEverything

- Teardowns, durability tests, device internals
- *Tip: Watch for understanding device construction, not repair procedures*

Linus Tech Tips

- General computer knowledge and hardware
- *Tip: Good for understanding components and compatibility*

Hugh Jeffreys

- iPhone and Mac repairs with commentary

- *Tip: Shows real problems you'll encounter, including mistakes and fixes*

Tronicsfix

- Game console and electronics repair
- *Tip: Great for understanding board-level diagnostics*

This Does Not Compute

- Vintage computer restoration
- *Tip: Relevant for e-waste projects and understanding older technology*

Safety Resources & Best Practices

iFixit Safety Guide

- https://www.ifixit.com/Guide/How+to+Prevent+Electrostatic+Discharge+(ESD)/8555
- *Tip: ESD can destroy components invisibly - always ground yourself*

Battery Safety Information

- https://www.ifixit.com/Wiki/What_to_do_with_a_swollen_battery
- *Tip: Never puncture lithium batteries. If swollen, handle with extreme care and dispose properly*

Essential Safety Rules:

- Always disconnect power and remove batteries first
- Use anti-static wrist strap or touch grounded metal frequently
- Work in well-lit, organized space
- Keep screws organized (use magnetic mat or pill organizer)
- Take photos during disassembly for reference
- Never force components - if it's stuck, find what's holding it
- Back up all data before repairs
- Document device condition with photos before starting
- *Tip: One misplaced screw can ruin a repair. Organization is everything*

Parts & Tools Resources

iFixit Store

- https://www.ifixit.com/Store
- High-quality tools and genuine parts
- *Tip: Their Pro Tech Toolkit is expensive but worth it for serious repairs*

Amazon/eBay

- Search for OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer) parts
- *Tip: Cheap parts often fail quickly. Read reviews carefully*

Batteries and Charging Ports

- *Tip: Always buy from reputable sellers. Counterfeit batteries can be dangerous*

RepairPartsUSA

- https://www.repairparts usa.com/
- Bulk parts for common repairs
- *Tip: Good for stocking up on common iPhone/Samsung parts*

E-Waste & Recycling Resources

EPA Electronics Recycling Guide

- https://www.epa.gov/recycle/electronics-donation-and-recycling
- Lists certified recyclers and drop-off locations

Best Buy Recycling Program

- Free recycling for most electronics
- *Tip: They accept even non-working devices*

Call2Recycle (Battery Recycling)

- https://www.call2recycle.org/
- Locations for safe battery disposal
- *Tip: Lithium batteries cannot go in regular trash*

Shrewsbury DPW

- https://www.shrewsburyma.gov/
- Check for local hazardous waste collection days

What to Accept for E-Waste:

- Phones, tablets, computers, laptops
- Cables, chargers, peripherals
- Monitors, TVs (check weight limits)
- Keyboards, mice, speakers
- *Tip: Test everything before recycling - many "broken" devices just need simple fixes*

What NOT to Accept:

- Major appliances (washers, fridges)

- Large furniture
- CRT monitors (unless you have proper disposal)
- *Tip: CRTs contain lead and require special handling*

Certification & Learning Paths

CompTIA A+ Certification

- https://www.comptia.org/certifications/a
- Industry-standard IT support certification
- *Tip: Not required but adds credibility if you want to formalize skills*

Professor Messer (Free A+ Training)

- https://www.professormesser.com/
- Complete free video course for A+ certification
- *Tip: Great resource even if you're not getting certified*

Apple Self Service Repair

- https://support.apple.com/self-service-repair
- Official Apple repair manuals and parts
- *Tip: Expensive but guarantees genuine parts*

Google IT Support Certificate (Coursera)

- https://www.coursera.org/professional-certificates/google-it-support
- Free to audit, covers fundamentals
- *Tip: Good for team members wanting structured learning*

Community & Support Forums

iFixit Answers

- https://www.ifixit.com/Answers
- Community Q&A for repair problems
- *Tip: Search before asking - most questions already answered*

Reddit r/mobilerepair

- https://www.reddit.com/r/mobilerepair/
- Active community of repair professionals
- *Tip: Great for troubleshooting unusual problems*

Reddit r/techsupport

- https://www.reddit.com/r/techsupport/
- Software troubleshooting help
- *Tip: Follow posting rules carefully*

Electronics Stack Exchange

- https://electronics.stackexchange.com/
- Technical questions about circuits and components
- *Tip: More advanced - use after building foundation*

Documentation & Organization Tips

Create Repair Logs:

- Device info (model, serial, condition)
- Problem description from client
- Diagnostic steps taken
- Parts used and cost
- Time spent
- Outcome and any follow-up needed
- *Tip: This builds your knowledge base and proves professional approach*

Photo Documentation:

- Before starting (all angles)
- During disassembly (screw positions, cable routing)
- Damaged components
- After completion
- *Tip: Photos protect you from liability claims and help during reassembly*

Build a Knowledge Base:

- Common problems and solutions for devices you see frequently
- Client FAQs
- Vendor contact info
- Part numbers for frequent replacements
- *Tip: Every repair teaches you something - document it*

Advanced Learning Resources

Microsoldering and Board Repair

REWA Technology (YouTube)

- Professional microsoldering tutorials
- *Tip: Don't attempt without proper equipment and significant practice*

iPad Rehab (YouTube)

- Jessa Jones's board repair techniques
- *Tip: Shows real business-level troubleshooting*

Data Recovery

Kroll Ontrack Data Recovery Resources

- https://www.ontrack.com/en-us/data-recovery
- Industry-standard techniques
- *Tip: Data recovery is a specialty - know when to refer out*

Circuit Board Repair

EEVBlog Forum

- https://www.eevblog.com/forum/
- Advanced electronics troubleshooting community
- *Tip: Deep technical discussions - bookmark for future reference*

Practice & Skill Building

Where to Get Practice Devices:

- Friends/family broken devices
- Thrift stores (cheap broken electronics)
- E-waste you collect
- Failed repair attempts from others
- *Tip: Practice disassembly on devices you don't care about breaking first*

Skills to Master First:

1. Proper screw organization
2. Gentle prying without breaking clips
3. Cable connector removal
4. Component testing with multimeter
5. Software diagnostics
- *Tip: Speed comes with practice. Focus on doing it right, not fast*

When to Stop and Refer Out

Know Your Limits:

- Liquid damage requiring board-level repair
- Microsoldering needs (broken pads, chip-level repair)

- Data recovery from failed drives
- Devices under warranty (advise client to use warranty)
- Repairs beyond your skill level
- *Tip: Being honest about limitations builds more trust than attempting beyond your skills*

Local Professional Referrals:

- Build relationships with local repair shops
- Have backup options for clients
- Know specialists (data recovery, board repair, etc.)

Quick Start Checklist for New Team Members

□ Read iFixit Electronics Skills Course □ Watch soldering tutorial and practice on scrap □ Familiarize with tool kit □ Read complete iFixit guide for one simple repair □ Practice disassembly on broken device □ Learn software diagnostic basics □ Review safety protocols □ Shadow experienced team member on actual repair □ Attempt first supervised repair □ Build documentation habits

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Tech Awareness Association - Empowering our community through technology education and repair

Emails

Sponsors

Sponsors

Tech Repair Club Sponsor Opportunities

Based on your proposal's mission of teaching device repair and reducing e-waste while providing community tech support, here are your best sponsorship opportunities:

Top Tier Prospects

iFixit represents your strongest potential partner. They directly support high school clubs focused on e-waste reduction and repair—in fact, they highlight *The IT Club*, a high school student-founded organization that refurbishes computers for underrepresented students, as one of their supported causes. Contact them at **education@ifixit.com**with your proposal emphasizing your e-waste mission and community partnerships with the library and senior center. Their programs provide devices, tools, and support at no cost to participants, and they've supported over 32,000 students across 102 universities.[1][2][3]

Best Buy Community Grants Program awards $5,000-$10,000 to community organizations offering tech education for teens ages 13-18 during out-of-school time. This perfectly matches your club format. They specifically fund robotics, computer programming, and technology-focused programs for underserved populations. Since Best Buy stores are within 50 miles of Worcester, you're eligible. Applications typically open April 1 annually.[4][5]

Shrewsbury Public Library Foundation and Friends of the Shrewsbury Public Library offer excellent local opportunities since your club directly partners with them for tech support services. The Friends organization already funds library events and scholarships and can award grants from their fundraising. Contact them at **splfriendsmembership@gmail.com** or **508-841-8609 x3**. This path is particularly promising since you have an established relationship with the library.[6]

Secondary Local Opportunities

Shrewsbury Youth and Family Services (SYFS) actively supports youth programs in your community. Contact **Fred Kaelin** at **** or **508-845-6932** to inquire about corporate sponsorship opportunities for youth education initiatives.[7]

Local tech repair businesses like **Geeks on Site** in Worcester (**508-425-7455**) or Holden Computer Repair may sponsor as part of community engagement. These businesses understand the value of repair education and could provide tools, expertise, or direct financial support.

State and National Funding

Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection (MassDEP) offers the Waste Reduction Innovation Grant (WRIG) for e-waste reduction projects, though awards range from $50,000-$2 million, making it better suited for larger initiatives.[8]

IEEE Foundation Grants and **Toshiba America Foundation** both fund STEM education and electronics-focused programs available in Massachusetts.[9]

Funding Resources

Use **STEMgrants.com** and **STEM Supplies' free funding finder** (stem-supplies.com/funding) to identify additional Massachusetts-specific opportunities as you develop your initial proposals.

Recommended Action Plan

1. **Start immediately** with iFixit (education@ifixit.com)—they're most aligned with your mission and have proven support for similar student clubs
2. **Research Best Buy's 2026 timeline** for grant applications (typically spring cycle)
3. **Meet with Shrewsbury Public Library Foundation** to propose a formal partnership donation
4. **Contact local tech businesses** directly with a brief sponsorship pitch
5. **Explore state funding** after securing initial sponsors to demonstrate traction

Your $500 goal is absolutely achievable, particularly through the library connection and local tech businesses. Start with iFixit and the library foundation, as these represent your most direct and mission-aligned opportunities.

⁂

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9. https://www.massrobotics.org/sponsors/
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13. https://www.starnetlibraries.org/the-best-buy-community-grants-program/

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16. https://www.apple.com/education-initiative/

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18. https://www.apple.com/education/docs/l501899b_fed_funds_for_apple_edu_solutions.pdf

19. https://syfs-ma.org/corporate-sponsorship/

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21. https://geeksonsite.com/us/massachusetts/worcester/computer-repair/

22. https://www.shrewsburytca.com/join

23. https://recyclingpartnership.org/grants/

24. https://www.yelp.com/search?cflt=electronicsrepair&find_loc=Worcester%2C+MA

25. https://www.bbb.org/us/ma/shrewsbury/category/non-profit-organizations

26. https://harmony1.com/recycling-equipment-grants/

27. https://www.reddit.com/r/WorcesterMA/comments/1laljor/computer_repair_shops/

28. https://www.shrewsburyma300.com/sponsors

29. https://stem-supplies.com/stem-resources/funding

30. https://shrewsburypubliclibrary.org/get_involved/spl-friends/

31. https://kidsintech.org/online-donation/

32. https://www.pltw.org/stem-grants

33. https://shrewsburypubliclibrary.org

34. https://www.worcestercountybar.org/community-engagement-resource-page/

35. https://stem-supplies.com/funding-finder

36. https://foundationspl.org

37. https://www.stemforallacademy.org/donate

38. https://stemgrants.com/stem-grants-for-k-12-nonprofits/

Southgate Email

Subject: Tech Awareness Association - Partnership Proposal for Senior Tech Support

Dear Southgate Senior Center Leadership,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization dedicated to making technology accessible and understandable for our community in Worcester County. I have volunteered at Southgate as a helper for senior activities before and had really enjoyed helping senior citizens. That experience inspired me to think of a way to use our Tech Awareness Association to assist seniors in comprehending and utilizing technology safely and effectively.

My dedication to this effort is personal. After my own grandparents were recently targeted by a sophisticated digital scam, the incident underscored a vital truth: our focus must be on empowering seniors to safely navigate a digital landscape fraught with risks. This experience drives our commitment to move beyond basic troubleshooting to proactive education on identifying and avoiding online threats, ensuring every resident gains confidence and true digital self-reliance.

Tech Awareness Association is a group of high school students who already partner with Shrewsbury Public Library for monthly device repair workshops. We have firsthand experience teaching technical concepts to people with varying comfort levels, and we're passionate about ensuring everyone has access to the digital tools that connect us to family, healthcare, and community.

We're reaching out to propose a partnership where we would provide regular, free tech support visits to Southgate Senior Center residents. Our goal is simple: help seniors gain confidence and independence with their devices through patientience.

We would like to help seniors with:

- Setting up apps and video calling to connect with family
- Managing phone storage and photos
- Understanding accessibility settings
- Identifying and avoiding online scams (phishing, tech support fraud, etc.)
- General troubleshooting for phones, tablets, and computers

We believe in teaching, not just fixing. We take the time to explain each step so residents can handle similar issues independently in the future. We understand that technology often excludes seniors not through complexity, but through lack of patience, and we are committed to bridging that gap.

We'd like to establish regular bi-weekly visits (or more frequently, based on your needs and availability). Sessions would be flexible and tailored to resident requests, whether that's small group lessons, or drop-in tech clinics.

We're happy to work around your existing programming and would greatly appreciate the opportunity to discuss how we can best support Southgate residents.

Could we schedule a brief meeting or call to discuss this partnership? I'd love to hear about the specific tech challenges your residents face and how we can be most helpful. Thank you for considering this partnership. We believe that everyone deserves to feel confident using technology, and we're excited about the possibility of serving the Southgate community.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Best Buy

Subject: Teen Tech Education Program - Best Buy Community Grant Application Inquiry

Dear Best Buy Community Grants Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm writing to inquire about the Best Buy Community Grants Program for our organization, Tech Awareness Association, a student-led technology education initiative serving teens and families in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts.

Tech Awareness Association teaches high school students and community members device repair, digital literacy, and responsible technology use through hands-on, out-of-school programming. We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center to provide free workshops and tech support.

Tech Awareness Association runs weekly hands-on repair workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching participants ages 13-18 (and their families) how to understand and repair smartphones and laptops, make informed technology purchasing decisions, reduce e-waste through sustainable practice, develop problem-solving and critical thinking skills, and gain confidence in STEM fields

We also provide regular tech support at Southgate Senior Center and organize an annual e-waste drive to keep electronics out of landfills.

Our impact goals are to Teach 100+ community members repair skills annually, divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills, and provide free tech education to underserved populations, especially seniors

We're run entirely by high school students with technical expertise from FRC robotics, electrical engineering projects, and self-taught repair skills. We've established formal partnerships with our public library and senior center, demonstrating sustainability and community support.

We're seeking modest sponsorship ($75-$500) to purchase repair tools and educational materials, expand outreach to more Shrewsbury families, develop curriculum for youth participants, and support our annual e-waste collection drive.

Could you provide guidance on the 2026 application timeline and any recommendations for strengthening our proposal?

Thank you for your time and for supporting teen tech education initiatives. We're excited about the possibility of partnering with Best Buy to expand our impact.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu

Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Subject: Teen Tech Education Program - Best Buy Community Grant Application Inquiry

Dear Best Buy Community Grants Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm writing to inquire about the Best Buy Community Grants Program for our organization, Tech Awareness Association, a student-led technology education initiative serving teens and families in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts.

Our Mission:

Tech Awareness Association teaches high school students and community members device repair, digital literacy, and responsible technology use through hands-on, out-of-school programming. We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center to provide free workshops and tech support.

Our core service is a 12-week workshop series that teaches participants, ages 13-18 and their families, how to understand and repair smartphones and laptops, make informed technology purchasing decisions, reduce e-waste through sustainable practices, develop problem-solving and critical thinking skills, and gain confidence in STEM fields. Beyond the workshop series, we run monthly repair workshops open to the whole community, senior tech support sessions where teen volunteers teach older adults, annual e-waste collection drives, and hands-on repair challenges and educational events.

Our program is a direct match for Best Buy's goals. First, we provide out-of-school STEM learning for ages 13-18, fulfilling your mission for teen tech education. Second, we serve families who cannot afford expensive repairs and seniors who lack tech confidence, addressing the need to support underserved populations. Finally, all of our programming is free and accessible, ensuring broad community impact.

We're seeking $5,000-$10,000 to purchase professional repair toolkits for workshop participants, acquire practice devices for educational teardowns, develop curriculum materials and safety equipment, and expand our programming to serve more students.

We're run entirely by high school students with technical expertise from FRC robotics, electrical engineering projects, and self-taught repair skills. We've established formal partnerships with our public library and senior center, demonstrating sustainability and community support.

We understand that Best Buy Community Grants typically open for applications in April. We wanted to reach out early to confirm our eligibility (we're within 50 miles of Worcester Best Buy locations), understand application requirements and the timeline for 2026, and ensure our programming aligns with your funding priorities.

Could you provide guidance on the 2026 application timeline and any recommendations for

strengthening our proposal?

Thank you for your time and for supporting teen tech education initiatives. We're excited about the possibility of partnering with Best Buy to expand our impact.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
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Student-Led Tech Education Initiative

Subject: Student-Led Tech Education Initiative - Partnership Opportunity

Dear Mr. Fred Kaelin,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-founded organization dedicated to teaching technology skills and reducing e-waste in Worcester County.

I'm reaching out because SYFS actively supports youth programming in Shrewsbury, and I believe our initiative aligns well with your mission of empowering young people and strengthening families.

Tech Awareness Association teaches community members,especially families and seniors how to repair and maintain their devices (phones, laptops, tablets), understand technology to make informed decisions, stay safe online and avoid scams, and reduce e-waste through sustainable practices

We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library for monthly workshops and Southgate Senior Center for tech support sessions.

Many Shrewsbury families face: expensive repair bills for simple device issues, lack of confidence in using technology effectively, vulnerability to online scams and digital safety threats and uncertainty about when to repair vs. replace devices.

Our workshops provide practical skills that save families money, build confidence, and promote digital safety, all for free.

As a student-led initiative, we're also demonstrating that young people can run professional community programs, teach and mentor across generations, address real community needs through service, and develop leadership and organizational skills.

We're modeling the kind of youth engagement SYFS promotes throughout Shrewsbury.

We're seeking modest sponsorship ($75-$500) to purchase repair tools and educational materials, expand outreach to more Shrewsbury families, develop curriculum for youth participants, and support our annual e-waste collection drive.

Alternatively, we'd appreciate help connecting with Shrewsbury families who could benefit from our services, promotion of our workshops through SYFS communications, or guidance on corporate sponsorship opportunities in town.

Supporting Tech Awareness Association allows SYFS to strengthen its youth leadership programming, provide practical life skills to families, support digital equity and accessibility, and promote environmental sustainability.

Would you be open to a brief conversation about how SYFS might support our work? I'd love to learn more about your priorities and explore how we can collaborate.

Thank you for your time and for all you do to support Shrewsbury's young people and families.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Geeks on Site

Subject: Community Partnership Opportunity - Student Tech Education Program

Dear Geeks on Site Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and digital literacy in Shrewsbury and Worcester County. I'm reaching out because as a local tech repair business, you understand the value of repair education, and I believe there's an opportunity for us to partner in serving our community.

We're high school students running free workshops that teach community members basic phone and laptop repair skills, when to attempt DIY repair versus seeking professional help, how to maintain devices to prevent problems, and online safety and scam prevention. We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center to reach families, seniors, and anyone who feels intimidated by technology.

Our workshops actually support professional repair businesses by educating customers about when DIY is appropriate and when they need a professional, building trust by teaching people to recognize quality repair services versus scams, creating awareness that repair is often worth it rather than just replacing devices, and generating referrals for complex issues beyond our scope. We're not competing with your business. We're creating more informed customers who value quality repair services.

We offer three levels of sponsorship to support our community programming. Bronze sponsorship at $75 includes recognition on our website and social media. Silver sponsorship at $200 provides logo placement on workshop materials, enhanced social media promotion, and recognition at library events. Gold sponsorship at $500 offers prominent branding on all materials, featured partner status on our website, priority referrals for complex repairs beyond our teaching scope, and speaking opportunities at our events. We provide impact reports showing people served and devices repaired, social media shoutouts and community recognition, and direct connection to potential customers who now understand the value of professional repair.

If financial sponsorship isn't feasible, we'd also appreciate donation of old or broken devices for educational demonstrations, occasional technical advice for complex issues we encounter, or guest speaking at a workshop about professional repair careers.

By sponsoring Tech Awareness Association, you're investing in the next generation of tech-literate consumers, supporting youth entrepreneurship and education, building goodwill in the local community, and promoting the value of repair in a throwaway culture.

Would you be open to a brief phone call to discuss this partnership? I'd love to hear your thoughts and explore how we can work together. Thank you for considering this opportunity. We appreciate all that local businesses like yours do for our community.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
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Computer Removal Team

Subject: Student E-Waste Initiative - Partnership Opportunity

Subject: Student E-Waste Initiative - Partnership Opportunity

Dear Computer Removal Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization in Shrewsbury focused on teaching device repair and reducing e-waste in Worcester County. I'm reaching out because your electronics recycling services align perfectly with a key component of our mission: keeping electronics out of landfills through responsible recycling and repair education.

We run free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching community members how to repair phones and laptops instead of discarding them, make informed repair versus replace decisions, understand the environmental impact of e-waste, and properly recycle electronics that can't be repaired. We're also organizing an annual community e-waste collection drive in Shrewsbury.

We'd like to establish a referral partnership where we educate our community about proper e-waste disposal and refer residents with electronics for recycling to Computer Removal, while you provide pickup and collection services for our annual e-waste drive. We would promote your services as our certified recycling partner throughout our programming.

For our e-waste drive, we're hoping to collect hundreds of pounds of electronics from Shrewsbury residents, ensure proper data destruction and recycling, and potentially generate revenue from recyclable materials to fund our educational programs. Would you be open to discussing how we might work together? We're looking for a reliable, local partner who can handle the collection and recycling responsibly.

We seek a sponsorship of $75-$500 for repair tools, educational mate

In return, you would receive direct referrals from our workshops and community network, recognition as our official e-waste recycling partner, community visibility through our library events and social media, and connection to environmentally conscious residents who value proper recycling.

Could we schedule a brief call to discuss your services and pricing for e-waste collection, partnership opportunities for our annual drive, and how we can best educate our community about your services?

Thank you for your time. We appreciate local businesses like yours that prioritize responsible electronics recycling.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Asset Recovery Services Team

Subject: Student-Led E-Waste Education Program - Partnership Inquiry

Dear Asset Recovery Services Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and e-waste reduction in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts. I'm reaching out because your IT Asset Disposition and secure recycling services would be an excellent fit for our community e-waste initiatives.

We run educational workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching residents how to repair and extend device lifespans, understand the environmental impact of electronic waste, make informed decisions about when to repair versus responsibly recycle, and practice proper e-waste disposal. We're also planning an annual community e-waste collection drive to keep harmful materials out of landfills.

We're seeking a certified ITAD partner who can provide secure data destruction services, handle our collected e-waste responsibly, potentially offer educational materials about proper recycling, and support our annual collection drive with pickup services. By partnering with Tech Awareness Association, you would receive referrals from our workshop participants, gain visibility as a responsible recycling partner in Shrewsbury, support youth-led environmental education, and connect with businesses and residents seeking certified e-waste services.

We're planning to collect old computers, laptops, and monitors, phones, tablets, and accessories, and electronic components requiring secure disposal. Many items will come from businesses and residents requiring data destruction services, exactly what you specialize in.

We offer three levels of sponsorship to support our mission. Bronze sponsorship at $75 includes recognition on our website and social media. Silver sponsorship at $200 provides logo placement on educational materials, enhanced social media promotion, and recognition at library events. Gold sponsorship at $500 offers prominent branding on all materials, featured partner status as our official ITAD partner, priority referrals, and speaking opportunities at our events.

Would you be open to discussing partnership opportunities for our e-waste collection drive, educational resources about secure recycling we could share with participants, and potential sponsorship of our environmental education programming? We're happy to recognize Asset Recovery Services as our official ITAD partner in all our materials and events.

Thank you for considering this opportunity. We appreciate your commitment to secure, responsible electronics recycling.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association

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Phone: (617) 206-7007

Staples Shrewsbury Tech Services Manager

Subject: Community Tech Education Partnership - Tech Awareness Association

Dear Staples Shrewsbury Tech Services Manager,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and technology skills in Shrewsbury. I'm reaching out because Staples has a strong commitment to community support and tech education, and I believe there's an opportunity for us to collaborate.

We run free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching residents basic device repair for phones and laptops, technology maintenance and troubleshooting, when DIY repair makes sense versus professional services, and online safety and scam prevention. We serve families, seniors, and anyone intimidated by technology.

Our workshops actually support businesses like Staples by teaching people when they need professional help versus simple fixes, creating more tech-literate customers who understand service value, building awareness that repair is often better than replacement, and educating people about quality tech services. We're not competing. We're creating informed consumers.

We offer three levels of sponsorship to expand our programming. Bronze sponsorship at $75 includes recognition on our website and social media. Silver sponsorship at $200 provides logo placement on workshop materials, enhanced social media promotion, and recognition at library events. Gold sponsorship at $500 offers prominent branding on all materials, featured partner status on our website, priority referrals for professional services beyond our teaching scope, and association with youth education and community service.

If financial sponsorship isn't feasible, we'd also appreciate donation of tech supplies such as cables, accessories, and organizational materials, discount on tools and materials for our workshops, gift cards for workshop prizes and incentives, or display space for our flyers in-store.

Your support would help us serve over 100 Shrewsbury residents in our first year, reduce e-waste through repair education, provide free tech skills training, and support senior digital literacy.

Would you be open to a brief conversation about partnership opportunities? I'm happy to stop by the store or arrange a call at your convenience. Thank you for considering this opportunity to support youth-led community education in Shrewsbury.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Macs at Work Team

Subject: Tech Education Partnership - Referral Opportunity

Dear Macs at Work Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair in Shrewsbury.

We run free workshops at Shrewsbury High School where we teach participants the basics of electronic repair.

Donation of broken Apple devices for educational demonstrations

- Guest presentation about professional Apple repair
- Technical advice for teaching basic Mac troubleshooting

Community Impact:

Many Shrewsbury residents use Apple devices but:

- Don't know when repair is possible vs. replacement
- Don't understand the difference between quality repair and quick fixes
- Are intimidated by tech services

We're educating them to become informed customers who value expertise.

Next Steps:

Would you be interested in discussing how we can work together? I'm happy to meet at your location or arrange a phone call.

Thank you for considering this partnership opportunity.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
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Tech Goes Home (Digital Equity Organization)

Subject: Student-Led Digital Literacy Initiative - Collaboration Inquiry

Dear Tech Goes Home Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization focused on technology education and digital equity in Worcester County.

I'm reaching out because our missions align closely, and I believe there may be opportunities for collaboration or knowledge-sharing.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and online safety through free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library and tech support sessions at Southgate Senior Center. We specifically focus on underserved populations, including:

- Seniors with limited tech confidence
- Families who can't afford expensive repairs or classes
- Anyone intimidated by technology

Why We're Reaching Out:

As a student-led organization, we're still building our curriculum and approach. Tech Goes Home has years of experience in digital literacy training, and we'd love to learn from your work.

Specifically, we're interested in:

- Best practices for teaching digital literacy to diverse populations
- Curriculum resources or frameworks we could adapt
- Partnership models with libraries and community centers
-

Potential Collaboration:

We're exploring whether there might be opportunities to:

- Share curriculum resources or teaching approaches
- Collaborate on grant applications for digital equity work
- Cross-promote programs in Worcester County
- Learn from Tech Goes Home's established methodology

We're also open to supporting Tech Goes Home's initiatives in any way that makes sense—whether through volunteering, event partnerships, or simply spreading awareness.

Our Ask:

Would you be open to a brief conversation about:

- Resources or guidance you could share with a student-led program
- Potential collaboration opportunities in Worcester area
- Best practices for sustainable digital literacy programming

We deeply respect the work Tech Goes Home has done and would love to learn from your experience.

Thank you for your time and for your commitment to digital equity.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
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Website: www.techawarenessma.com
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Collaborate Solutions Team

Subject: Community Tech Education Initiative - Local Partnership Opportunity

Dear Collaborate Solutions Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and digital literacy in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because as a local IT services company serving Shrewsbury businesses, you understand the importance of technology education and cybersecurity awareness—both key components of our community programming.

What We Do:

We run free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching:

- Basic device repair and maintenance
- Digital literacy fundamentals
- Online safety and scam prevention
- Responsible technology practices

We serve families, seniors, and small businesses who need accessible tech education.

Partnership Opportunity:

Sponsorship ask

Alternative Collaboration:

- Guest presentation on cybersecurity best practices for small businesses
- Donation of old equipment for educational demonstrations
- Advice on enterprise-level tech issues we encounter

Community Impact:

Your support would help us:

- Serve 100+ Shrewsbury residents and small business owners
- Provide free cybersecurity awareness education
- Build digital literacy in our community
- Support local youth leadership

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a brief conversation about how Collaborate Solutions might partner with our community education initiative?

Thank you for considering this opportunity to invest in Shrewsbury's tech-literate future.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
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Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Prowess IT (IT Services)

Subject: Student Tech Education Program - Partnership & Referral Opportunity

Dear Prowess IT Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing technology education in Shrewsbury.

As a local IT services provider specializing in network support and hardware procurement, you understand that educated clients make better technology decisions—and that's exactly what we're creating through our community workshops.

Our Mission:

We teach Shrewsbury residents:

- Device repair and maintenance fundamentals
- When DIY solutions work vs. when professional help is needed
- How to extend hardware lifespan through proper care
- Technology decision-making skills

We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center for free community programming.

Partnership Proposal:

Sponsorship Option: $75-$500

Alternative Support:

- Donation of decommissioned hardware for educational use
- Guest speaker session on professional IT services
- Networking equipment for demonstration purposes

Community Value:

Your partnership would enable us to:

- Educate 100+ community members about proper technology practices
- Reduce unnecessary hardware waste
- Build digital literacy across generations
- Support student-led community initiatives

Next Steps:

Could we schedule a brief call to discuss partnership opportunities? I'd love to explore how Prowess IT and Tech Awareness Association can collaborate.

Thank you for your consideration and for serving the Shrewsbury business community.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Skywatch IT (IT Services)

Subject: Community Technology Education - Partnership Inquiry

Dear Skywatch IT Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization focused on technology education and digital literacy in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because as an IT consulting and remote support provider, you understand the value of proactive technology education—which is exactly what we're delivering to the Shrewsbury community.

What We're Building:

Tech Awareness Association runs free workshops teaching:

- Device troubleshooting and basic repair
- Remote support readiness (helping people describe tech issues effectively)
- System monitoring awareness (recognizing when devices need attention)
- Technology maintenance best practices

Our programming serves families, seniors, and individuals who struggle with technology.

Partnership Opportunity:

Sponsorship Level: $75-$500

Alternative Collaboration:

- Educational presentation on professional remote IT support
- Donation of monitoring tools or software for demonstrations
- Old devices

Community Impact:

Your support helps us:

- Serve 100+ Shrewsbury residents with free tech education
- Build digital literacy and confidence
- Reduce technology anxiety and frustration
- Empower youth-led community service

Next Steps:

Would you be interested in a brief conversation about partnership opportunities? I'm happy to arrange a call at your convenience.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to invest in our community's technology education.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Shrewsbury Electric & Cable Operations (SELCO)

Subject: Digital Equity Partnership - Tech Awareness Association

Dear SELCO Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization dedicated to improving technology access and literacy in Shrewsbury.

As Shrewsbury's municipal utility provider for internet services, SELCO plays a crucial role in connecting our community. We'd like to partner with you to ensure residents can effectively use the connectivity you provide.

Our Mission:

We teach Shrewsbury residents:

- How to maximize their internet and technology services
- Device maintenance and troubleshooting
- Online safety and digital literacy
- Responsible technology use

We run free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library and provide tech support at Southgate Senior Center.

Partnership Proposal:

- **Old devices**

Option 2: Sponsorship ($75-$500)

Community Benefits:

This partnership would:

- Support youth-led community initiatives
- Bridge the digital divide in Shrewsbury

Next Steps:

Would you be open to discussing how SELCO and Tech Awareness Association can collaborate to improve digital literacy in Shrewsbury?

Thank you for powering our community's connectivity and for considering this partnership.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
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Technology Services – Town of Shrewsbury

Subject: Student-Led Tech Education Initiative - Municipal Partnership Opportunity

Dear Town of Shrewsbury Technology Services,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing free technology education to Shrewsbury residents.

I'm reaching out because as the town's IT infrastructure team, you understand the importance of digital literacy and technology access for all residents. We believe there's an opportunity for collaboration between our youth-led initiative and municipal technology services.

What We're Doing:

Tech Awareness Association teaches Shrewsbury residents:

- Basic device repair and maintenance
- Digital literacy and online safety
- E-waste reduction through repair education
- Technology confidence-building

We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center to provide accessible programming.

How We Could Collaborate:

- Cross-promotion of our workshops through town communications
- Potential collaboration on municipal e-waste collection initiatives
- Recognition as a town-supported youth initiative

Request for Support:

We're seeking:

- Guidance on municipal technology education priorities
- Sponsorship($75-500)
- Old devices

Community Value:

Our initiative:

- Empowers Shrewsbury residents with practical skills
- Reduces technology anxiety and builds confidence
- Keeps electronics out of landfills
- Models youth leadership and community service
- Provides free education saving residents hundreds of dollars

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a brief meeting to discuss:

- How we can align with town technology priorities
- Potential collaboration opportunities
- Ways to amplify our community impact

Thank you for your service to Shrewsbury and for considering support of this student-led community initiative.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
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Shrewsbury Public Schools – Technology Department

Subject: Student Tech Initiative - Potential Collaboration with SPS

Dear Shrewsbury Public Schools Technology Department,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm a junior at Shrewsbury High School and the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing technology education to our community.

I'm reaching out because as fellow Shrewsbury High students, we're running a community initiative that aligns with SPS's mission of technology education and student leadership—and we'd love to explore collaboration opportunities.

Our Program:

Tech Awareness Association teaches community members (including SPS families) how to:

- Repair and maintain devices
- Practice online safety
- Understand technology fundamentals
- Reduce e-waste through responsible practices

We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center for free workshops.

SPS Connection:

This initiative:

- Is entirely student-led by Shrewsbury High students
- Demonstrates real-world application of STEM skills
- Serves SPS families and community members
- Models civic engagement and youth leadership
- Could potentially benefit SPS families struggling with device costs

Potential Collaboration:

Option 1: Community Outreach

- Promote our workshops to SPS families needing tech support
- Feature our initiative in SPS communications as student leadership example
- Connect us with families who could benefit from free device education

Option 2: Educational Partnership

- Student volunteers gain service learning hours
- Potential collaboration on e-waste collection initiatives
- Guest presentations on device maintenance for interested students

- Partnership on digital literacy programming

Option 3: Device Donation

- SPS donates decommissioned devices for our educational workshops
- We teach repair skills using real equipment
- Properly recycle devices that can't be repaired

No Cost to SPS:

We're not requesting funding—simply collaboration, promotion, or device donations that would otherwise be recycled.

Benefits for SPS:

- Showcases student initiative and community service
- Provides free tech education to SPS families
- Supports digital equity in Shrewsbury
- Demonstrates SPS commitment to sustainability
- Highlights student STEM application beyond classroom

Student Team:

Our team includes SHS students involved in robotics, engineering, and community service who want to make a practical difference in Shrewsbury.

Next Steps:

Would you be open to discussing:

- How SPS might support or promote our initiative
- Potential device donation opportunities
- Ways we can collaborate on community technology education

Thank you for supporting student innovation and community service at SPS.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Peterson & Ryan Law

Subject: Community Youth Initiative - Pro Bono Partnership Inquiry

Dear Attorney Neil Peterson and Attorney Ryan,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led nonprofit organization providing technology education in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because as a local law firm committed to community service, you may be interested in supporting a youth-led initiative that serves Shrewsbury residents—and we could benefit from legal guidance as we formalize our organization.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association teaches community members:

- Device repair and technology maintenance
- Digital literacy and online safety
- E-waste reduction through responsible practices

We partner with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center for free programming.

Why We're Reaching Out:

As we grow, we're navigating:

- Organizational structure (nonprofit formation considerations)
- Liability and insurance for workshop activities
- Partnership agreements with community organizations
- Intellectual property (curriculum, materials, branding)
- Volunteer management and safety protocols

Partnership Request:

We're seeking pro bono or reduced-fee legal guidance to help us:

- Understand organizational structure options (informal vs. formal nonprofit)
- Review partnership agreements with library and senior center
- Develop appropriate liability waivers for workshop participants
- Ensure compliance with youth-led organization requirements

What We Offer in Return:

- Recognition as our legal advisor in all materials
- Social media and community visibility
- Association with youth education and community service
- Positive local reputation for supporting student initiatives

- Potential referrals from community members we serve

Community Impact:

Your support would enable us to:

- Operate professionally and safely
- Serve 100+ Shrewsbury residents confidently
- Model proper organizational practices for student leaders
- Build a sustainable community program

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a brief consultation to discuss:

- Our legal questions and organizational needs
- Potential pro bono or reduced-fee arrangement
- How Peterson & Ryan might support our initiative

We understand your time is valuable and are happy to work within whatever capacity makes sense for your firm.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to support youth-led community service in Shrewsbury.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

St. Pierre & St. Pierre PC

Subject: Student Organization Legal Guidance - Pro Bono Partnership Request

Dear Attorney Jason St. Pierre,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-founded organization providing free technology education in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because as a Shrewsbury law firm with expertise in business matters, you may be interested in supporting a local youth initiative—and providing legal guidance as we formalize our community organization.

Our Mission:

We teach Shrewsbury residents device repair, digital literacy, and online safety through hands-on workshops at the public library and senior center. Our goal is to make technology accessible, repairable, and understandable for everyone.

Legal Guidance Needs:

As we expand our programming, we need guidance on:

- Organizational structure and formation (nonprofit considerations)
- Liability protection for youth-led workshops
- Partnership agreements with community organizations
- Volunteer management and insurance requirements
- Basic business practices for sustainable operations

Partnership Proposal:

We're seeking pro bono or reduced-fee legal consultation to help us:

- Review and improve our organizational documents
- Understand liability and insurance needs for workshops
- Draft appropriate agreements with library and senior center partners
- Ensure legal compliance as a student-led organization

Value for Your Firm:

- Recognition as legal advisor in our materials and communications
- Community visibility through our library and senior center partnerships
- Association with youth leadership and education
- Positive reputation for supporting student initiatives
- Potential client referrals from community members we serve

Community Impact:

With proper legal foundation, we can:

- Serve 100+ Shrewsbury residents safely and professionally
- Build a sustainable model for youth-led community service
- Demonstrate responsible organizational practices
- Expand our impact across Worcester County

No Expectation of Extensive Time:

We're not seeking ongoing representation—just initial guidance to ensure we're operating properly as we formalize our organization.

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a brief consultation to discuss:

- Our specific legal questions
- Potential pro bono or reduced-fee arrangement
- How St. Pierre & St. Pierre might support our work

Thank you for considering this opportunity to invest in Shrewsbury's youth-led community initiatives.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

McLaren & Associates CPAs, PC

Subject: Student Nonprofit Organization - Pro Bono Financial Guidance Request

Dear McLaren & Associates Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing free technology education in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because as a local CPA firm serving Shrewsbury businesses, you may be interested in supporting a youth-led community initiative—and providing financial guidance as we establish sustainable operations.

Our Organization:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and online safety to Shrewsbury residents through partnerships with the public library and senior center. All programming is free and community-focused.

Financial Guidance Needs:

As we formalize our organization, we need help with:

- Basic bookkeeping and financial record-keeping
- Understanding nonprofit financial requirements and reporting
- Managing small-scale fundraising and donations
- Budgeting for sustainable operations
- Tax compliance for youth-led organizations

Partnership Request:

We're seeking pro bono or reduced-fee consultation to help us:

- Set up simple, appropriate financial tracking systems
- Understand tax and reporting obligations
- Establish good financial practices from the start
- Ensure transparency and accountability

Value for Your Firm:

- Recognition as financial advisor in our materials
- Community visibility through library and senior center partnerships
- Association with youth education and community service
- Demonstration of commitment to local nonprofits
- Positive reputation for supporting student initiatives

Financial Scope:

Our initial operations are modest:

- Small donations and sponsorships ($500-$2,000 annually initially)
- Basic expense tracking (tools, materials, supplies)
- Simple revenue streams (e-waste recycling, 3D-printed item sales)

We need guidance to handle these properly, not complex tax services.

Community Impact:

Proper financial foundation enables us to:

- Operate transparently and professionally
- Build trust with sponsors and partners
- Model responsible financial practices for student leaders
- Grow sustainably to serve more residents

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a brief consultation to discuss:

- Our financial setup needs
- Potential pro bono or reduced-fee arrangement
- How McLaren & Associates might support our initiative

We understand your expertise is valuable and are grateful for any guidance you can provide.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to support Shrewsbury's youth-led community service.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Reliant Medical Group – Shrewsbury

Subject: Senior Tech Education Partnership - Digital Health Literacy Initiative

Dear Reliant Medical Group Shrewsbury Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization focused on technology education for underserved populations in Shrewsbury.

I'm reaching out because healthcare increasingly depends on digital tools—patient portals, telehealth, health apps—and many of your senior patients struggle with the technology needed to access these services.

The Problem We're Addressing:

Many seniors face barriers to healthcare technology:

- Can't access patient portals to view test results
- Struggle with telehealth appointment setup
- Don't understand health monitoring apps
- Are vulnerable to health-related scams
- Miss important communications sent digitally

Our Solution:

Tech Awareness Association provides free, patient-focused tech support teaching seniors:

- How to access and navigate patient portals
- Setting up and using telehealth platforms
- Understanding health apps and wearables
- Identifying medical scams and phishing
- Managing photos/documents for healthcare providers

We currently partner with Southgate Senior Center for regular tech support sessions.

Partnership Opportunity:

We'd like to collaborate with Reliant Medical Group to improve digital health literacy among your senior patients:

Option 1: Patient Referral Program

- Reliant staff refer patients struggling with digital health tools to our free workshops
- We provide targeted support on healthcare technology
- Patients gain confidence accessing Reliant's digital services

Option 2: On-Site Education Sessions

- We provide tech support workshops at Reliant Shrewsbury location
- Focus specifically on Reliant patient portal and telehealth platforms
- Help patients maximize their access to your services

Option 3: Sponsorship Partnership ($500-$1,000)

- Reliant sponsors our senior tech education program
- We provide regular reporting on patients helped
- Recognition as healthcare partner committed to accessibility

Benefits for Reliant:

- Improved patient engagement with digital health tools
- Reduced staff time explaining portal access
- Better telehealth adoption among senior patients
- Fewer missed appointments due to technology barriers
- Community visibility as supporter of digital health equity

Our Credentials:

- Partnership with Southgate Senior Center for senior tech support
- Patient, judgment-free teaching approach
- Experience explaining technology to non-technical users
- Commitment to privacy and security education

Next Steps:

Would you be open to discussing how Reliant Medical Group and Tech Awareness Association can collaborate to improve digital health access for senior patients?

Thank you for your commitment to patient care and for considering this partnership.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

UMass Chan Medical School – Shrewsbury Campus

Subject: Student STEM Initiative - Educational Partnership Opportunity

Dear UMass Chan Medical School Shrewsbury Campus,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led STEM education organization serving the Shrewsbury community.

I'm reaching out because UMass Chan has a strong commitment to community engagement and STEM education—and we believe there may be collaboration opportunities between your research/training programs and our community technology initiative.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association provides free technology education teaching:

- Device repair and electronics fundamentals
- Problem-solving and systematic troubleshooting
- Digital literacy and online safety
- Environmental responsibility (e-waste reduction)

We serve diverse populations including seniors, families, and students interested in STEM fields.

Potential Collaboration Areas:

1. Student Volunteering/Service Learning

- UMass Chan students volunteer with our workshops
- Gain community engagement experience
- Practice teaching complex concepts accessibly
- Fulfill service or outreach requirements

2. Educational Partnership

- Guest presentations on medical technology or digital health
- Collaboration on senior health technology literacy
- Cross-promotion of STEM education initiatives

3. Community Research Opportunity

- Study impact of technology education on senior populations
- Evaluate digital literacy interventions
- Research e-waste awareness and behavior change

4. Equipment Donation

- Donation of decommissioned medical/office electronics
- Devices for educational demonstrations and repair practice
- Support our e-waste education and recycling initiatives

Benefits for UMass Chan:

- Community engagement and visibility in Shrewsbury
- Practical application of medical school's community mission
- Connection with local STEM students (potential future applicants)
- Research opportunities on technology education impact
- Partnership with established community organizations (library, senior center)

Our Community Partnerships:

- Shrewsbury Public Library (monthly workshops)
- Southgate Senior Center (regular tech support)
- Local recycling facilities (e-waste initiatives)

Next Steps:

Would you be open to discussing potential collaboration between UMass Chan Shrewsbury and Tech Awareness Association?

Specifically, we'd love to explore:

- Student volunteer opportunities
- Equipment donation possibilities
- Educational partnership potential
- Research collaboration options

Thank you for your commitment to community health and education. We're excited about the possibility of partnering with UMass Chan.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
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Website: www.techawarenessma.com
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Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Tech Goes Home

DOUBLE ENTRY(PICK BETTER VERSION)

To: volunteer@techgoeshome.org
Subject: Student-Led Digital Literacy Initiative - Collaboration Inquiry

Dear Tech Goes Home Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization focused on technology education and digital equity in Worcester County, Massachusetts.

I'm reaching out because our missions align closely, and I believe there may be opportunities for collaboration or knowledge-sharing between our organizations.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and online safety through free workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library and tech support sessions at Southgate Senior Center. We specifically focus on underserved populations, including:

- Seniors with limited tech confidence
- Families who can't afford expensive repairs or classes
- Anyone intimidated by technology

Our 12-week workshop series covers:

- Device repair basics (phones and laptops)
- Technology maintenance and troubleshooting
- Online safety and scam prevention
- Digital literacy fundamentals
- E-waste awareness and sustainable practices
- Making informed technology purchasing decisions

Why We're Reaching Out:

As a student-led organization, we're still building our curriculum and approach. Tech Goes Home has years of experience in digital literacy training and has successfully served thousands of learners across Eastern Massachusetts. We'd love to learn from your work and expertise.

Specifically, we're interested in:

- Best practices for teaching digital literacy to diverse populations
- Curriculum resources or frameworks we could adapt for our community
- Strategies for measuring impact and program effectiveness
- Partnership models with libraries and community centers
- Approaches to working with English language learners and seniors

- Methods for ensuring long-term program sustainability

What We Bring:

While we're newer to this work, we offer:

- Youth perspective on technology education and engagement
- Hands-on device repair expertise (unique component of our program)
- Strong local partnerships in Shrewsbury/Worcester area (Shrewsbury Public Library, Southgate Senior Center)
- Student energy, enthusiasm, and community connections
- Focus on both repair skills and digital literacy (bridging hardware and software knowledge)

Our Team:

We're a group of five high school students with hands-on experience in:

- FRC robotics programming and electrical systems
- Device repair and troubleshooting
- Teaching and tutoring technical concepts
- Community service and youth leadership

We're committed to the "teach, don't fix" philosophy—empowering participants with skills they'll use for life rather than creating dependency.

Potential Collaboration:

We're exploring whether there might be opportunities to:

- Share curriculum resources or teaching approaches (with proper attribution)
- Collaborate on grant applications for digital equity work in Worcester County
- Cross-promote programs to reach more people in our shared service area
- Learn from Tech Goes Home's established methodology and 20+ years of experience
- Participate in any training or professional development opportunities you offer
- Connect with your Worcester area partnerships (I noticed you've been expanding work in Worcester)

We're also open to supporting Tech Goes Home's initiatives in any way that makes sense—whether through:

- Volunteering at Tech Goes Home programs
- Event partnerships or joint community programming
- Spreading awareness about your work in our networks
- Serving as youth ambassadors for digital equity in our communities

Our Impact Goals:

Through our library and senior center partnerships, we aim to:

- Serve 100+ Shrewsbury residents in our first year
- Divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills through our annual collection drive
- Provide free tech education that would otherwise cost hundreds of dollars per person
- Bridge the digital divide by offering accessible, judgment-free learning
- Create a sustainable model for youth-led digital equity work

Recognition of Your Work:

We've been inspired by Tech Goes Home's comprehensive approach to digital inclusion—not just providing training, but also addressing access barriers through device distribution and internet connectivity support. Your focus on outcomes (helping people pursue economic mobility, support academic achievement, and access critical resources) aligns perfectly with what we're trying to achieve in our community.

We particularly admire your community-based partnership model and your commitment to addressing digital exclusion as part of broader systemic inequities. As a student-led organization, we want to ensure we're approaching this work thoughtfully and learning from organizations like yours that have deep expertise.

Our Ask:

Would you be open to a brief conversation (phone call or video meeting) about:

- Resources or guidance you could share with a student-led program just getting started
- Potential collaboration opportunities in Worcester County area
- Best practices for sustainable digital literacy programming
- How we can support or complement Tech Goes Home's work rather than duplicate efforts

We understand your team is busy doing important work, and we're grateful for any time or insights you can share. Even a 15-20 minute conversation would be incredibly valuable as we build our program.

Additional Context:

We're currently in the process of:

- Finalizing our 12-week curriculum for library workshops (starting late January 2026)
- Establishing regular tech support visits at Southgate Senior Center
- Planning our first annual community e-waste collection drive
- Applying for grants and seeking local sponsorships
- Building sustainable operational structures

Any advice, resources, or connections you could provide would help us serve our community more effectively and avoid common pitfalls that new organizations face.

Next Steps:

If you're interested in connecting, I'm happy to:

- Schedule a call at your convenience
- Visit your Boston office if that's easier
- Attend any Tech Goes Home events or training sessions that are open to community partners
- Provide more detailed information about our programming and goals

Thank you for your time and for your incredible commitment to digital equity over the past 20+ years. The work Tech Goes Home does—graduating 22,000 learners and distributing 14,500 computers in just five years—is truly inspiring and exactly the kind of impact we hope to achieve in our community.

We deeply respect the work you've done and would be honored to learn from your experience.

Looking forward to hopefully connecting.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

P.S. I noticed Tech Goes Home has been expanding work in Worcester (including hiring Marwa Alnaal to lead advocacy work there). We'd love to learn more about your Worcester County initiatives and explore how we might support or complement that work in the Shrewsbury area.

Give IT Get IT Massachusetts

To: info@giveitgetit.org
Subject: Student Tech Repair Program - Device Donation Partnership Request

Dear Give IT Get IT Massachusetts Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and e-waste reduction in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts.

I'm reaching out because Give IT Get IT's device donation and refurbishment program aligns perfectly with our educational mission—and we believe there's an opportunity for meaningful collaboration.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association runs hands-on repair workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library teaching community members how to:

- Repair phones and laptops instead of discarding them
- Make informed technology decisions
- Reduce e-waste through sustainable practices
- Gain confidence with technology

We also provide regular tech support at Southgate Senior Center and organize annual e-waste collection drives.

Why We're Reaching Out:

We're seeking donated devices for our educational programming. Specifically, we need:

- Non-working phones and laptops for teaching disassembly and repair
- Practice devices for hands-on workshops
- Repairable electronics we can refurbish with students

These devices don't need to work—in fact, broken devices are ideal for teaching repair fundamentals.

How This Partnership Works:

- You provide refurbished or non-working devices for educational use
- We teach 100+ community members repair skills using these devices
- We properly recycle any devices beyond repair through certified facilities
- We recognize Give IT Get IT as our device donation partner in all materials

Our Impact:

Through your support, we would:

- Teach repair skills to underserved populations (seniors, families)
- Divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills
- Build digital literacy across Worcester County
- Model sustainable technology practices

Partnership Recognition:

- Logo on workshop materials and website
- Social media recognition
- Partnership acknowledgment in grant applications
- Impact reports showing devices used for education

Next Steps:

Would you be open to discussing how Give IT Get IT might support our educational mission through device donations? We're happy to work within whatever donation framework makes sense for your organization.

Thank you for your commitment to device access and sustainability. We're excited about the possibility of partnering with you.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

iFixit Foundation

To: education@ifixit.com
Attn: Marty Rippens, Director of Education Services
Subject: High School Repair Education Partnership - Tech Awareness Association

Dear Marty and iFixit Foundation Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-founded organization in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts dedicated to teaching device repair, reducing e-waste, and empowering our community through hands-on technology education.

I'm reaching out because iFixit Foundation's mission of teaching repair and promoting repairable product design aligns perfectly with what we're building—and we believe our program would be an excellent fit for your educational partnership program.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association runs monthly hands-on repair workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library, teaching community members how to:

- Replace batteries and screens on phones
- Maintain and upgrade laptops
- Diagnose common device issues
- Make informed repair-vs-replace decisions

We also provide regular tech support at Southgate Senior Center and organize an annual e-waste drive to keep electronics out of landfills.

Our Educational Approach:

We use iFixit guides extensively in our workshops and follow a "teach, don't fix-for" philosophy—empowering participants with skills they'll use for life rather than creating dependency. Our 12-week curriculum covers everything from understanding device internals to preventing problems through proper maintenance.

Our Impact Goals:

- Teach 100+ community members repair skills annually
- Divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills
- Provide free tech education to underserved populations, especially seniors
- Build Right to Repair awareness in our community

Why We're Reaching Out:

We're limited by:

- Access to quality tools for teaching workshops
- Donated devices that often lack parts needed for educational demonstrations
- Resources to expand our programming to more community members

We're hoping to explore iFixit Foundation's education partnership program to help us:

1. Provide participants with professional-quality tools during workshops
2. Access repair guides and curriculum resources
3. Obtain educational materials and potential device/tool donations
4. Build credibility as we apply for grants and expand our reach

Our Team:

We're five high school students with hands-on repair experience through:

- FRC robotics programming and electrical systems
- Personal device repair projects
- Teaching and tutoring technical concepts
- Community service and youth leadership

We've formalized our organization with clear roles, established partnerships with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center, and demonstrated commitment to sustainable growth.

Community Partnerships:

- Shrewsbury Public Library (monthly workshop host)
- Southgate Senior Center (regular tech support visits)
- Local recycling facilities (e-waste collection partners)

Request:

Would you be open to a conversation about how iFixit Foundation might support our mission? We'd love to learn more about:

- Your education partnership program requirements
- Available resources for student-led repair initiatives
- How we can collaborate to make repair accessible in Worcester County
- Potential for educational materials or tool donations

We're committed to the Right to Repair movement and want to build a sustainable model that empowers our community while promoting repairable technology.

Thank you for considering our request. We're excited about the possibility of joining the iFixit Foundation education community and continuing to use your incredible resources to teach repair skills.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Massachusetts Broadband Institute (MBI)

To: broadband@masstech.org
Subject: Device Distribution Application - Tech Awareness Association Educational Program

Dear Massachusetts Broadband Institute Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing technology education and digital equity programming in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts.

I'm writing to inquire about the Connected and Online Program's device distribution initiative and explore whether our educational programming qualifies for support.

Our Organization:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and online safety through:

- Monthly hands-on workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library
- Regular tech support visits at Southgate Senior Center
- Annual e-waste collection drives
- Community repair events

All programming is free and specifically serves underserved populations including seniors, families struggling with device costs, and anyone intimidated by technology.

Device Distribution Need:

We're seeking devices (minimum 30, ideally 50-100) for:

Educational Use:

- Teaching workshops where participants learn repair on practice devices
- Hands-on demonstrations of device internals and components
- Safe teardown sessions to understand technology

Community Distribution:

- Refurbished devices for seniors who lack technology access
- Laptops/tablets for families who can't afford devices
- Technology access for digital literacy students

Our Digital Equity Impact:

Through device distribution, we would:

- Provide technology access to 50-100 underserved Shrewsbury residents
- Teach repair skills so recipients can maintain their devices

- Offer ongoing tech support through our senior center visits
- Reduce e-waste by extending device lifespans through education

Alignment with MBI Goals:

Our program directly supports digital equity by:

- Addressing device access barriers
- Teaching sustainable technology practices
- Providing ongoing support, not just one-time distribution
- Focusing on populations often excluded from technology

Organizational Capacity:

We have:

- Established partnerships with Shrewsbury Public Library and Southgate Senior Center
- Student team with technical expertise (FRC robotics, device repair experience)
- Structured programming with measurable impact goals
- Secure storage and distribution systems through library partnership

Application Questions:

1. Does our educational/community distribution model qualify for the Connected and Online Program?
2. What is the application timeline and process through the Submittable portal?
3. Are there specific device types available (laptops, tablets, Chromebooks)?
4. What reporting requirements exist for device distribution tracking?

Next Steps:

We're ready to submit a formal application through your Submittable portal. Could you provide guidance on:

- Application requirements and timeline
- Documentation needed to demonstrate organizational capacity
- Any preferences for educational vs. direct distribution models

Thank you for your work promoting digital equity across Massachusetts. Device access is a critical barrier for many in our community, and your program could significantly expand our impact.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu

Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Organization Address: c/o Shrewsbury Public Library, 609 Main Street, Shrewsbury, MA 01545

TechSoup

To: solutions@techsoup.org
Subject: Nonprofit Technology Marketplace Registration - Tech Awareness Association

Dear TechSoup Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led nonprofit organization providing free technology education in Shrewsbury, Massachusetts.

I'm writing to register our organization with TechSoup's nonprofit technology marketplace and explore the resources available for educational technology programs.

Our Organization:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and e-waste reduction through:

- Monthly workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library
- Tech support at Southgate Senior Center
- Annual community e-waste drives
- Hands-on repair education events

All services are provided free to underserved populations including seniors, families, and anyone struggling with technology.

Technology Needs:

We're seeking access to discounted technology resources for:

Workshop Equipment:

- Tablets for educational demonstrations
- Laptops for teaching repair and maintenance
- Software for curriculum development and program management

Program Operations:

- Office software for documentation and impact tracking
- Educational tools for creating workshop materials
- Communication platforms for volunteer coordination

Community Distribution:

- Refurbished devices for seniors and families lacking technology access
- Equipment for hands-on learning during workshops

Nonprofit Status:

We're currently operating as a student-led community organization in partnership with:

- Shrewsbury Public Library (fiscal sponsor relationship)
- Southgate Senior Center (community partner)
- Local environmental and STEM organizations

Questions About TechSoup:

1. What documentation is required for student-led/library-partnered organizations?
2. Can we access discounted devices for both educational use and community distribution?
3. Are there specific corporate donation programs relevant to repair education?
4. How do we connect with donors focused on digital equity and e-waste reduction?

Our Impact:

Through TechSoup resources, we would:

- Expand workshops to serve 100+ community members annually
- Provide technology access to underserved populations
- Build sustainable repair education programming
- Reduce e-waste through education and device refurbishment

Connection to Corporate Donors:

We're particularly interested in TechSoup's connections to:

- Technology companies with device donation programs
- Corporate sponsors focused on digital equity
- Environmental organizations supporting e-waste reduction

Next Steps:

Could you provide guidance on:

- Registration process for student-led organizations
- Documentation required for library-partnered nonprofits
- Best practices for accessing discounted technology
- Corporate donation programs most relevant to our mission

Thank you for connecting nonprofits with technology resources. Access to quality equipment is essential for expanding our community impact.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Technocopia Makerspace (Worcester)

To: info@technocopia.org
Attn: Eric Sutman, Executive Director
Subject: Student Maker Initiative - Partnership & Equipment Collaboration Opportunity

Dear Eric and Technocopia Team,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization teaching device repair and maker skills in Shrewsbury, just minutes from Worcester.

I'm reaching out because Technocopia's commitment to community making and accessible tools aligns perfectly with our mission—and I believe there are natural collaboration opportunities between our organizations.

What We Do:

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair and technology skills through:

- Monthly workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library
- Tech support at Southgate Senior Center
- Hands-on repair and maker education
- E-waste reduction initiatives

We also use 3D printing with recycled filament to create phone cases and accessories, teaching sustainable manufacturing.

Why We're Reaching Out:

As a student-led maker initiative, we're seeking:

Equipment/Tool Support:

- Access to maker equipment for advanced projects
- Potential equipment donations for our library workshops
- 3D printing resources and recycled filament
- Electronics repair tools and components

Collaboration Opportunities:

- Co-hosted workshops combining repair and making
- Maker education for our student team
- Joint community events promoting Right to Repair
- Shared resources for e-waste and sustainable making

Facility Partnership:

- Occasional use of Technocopia space for special workshops
- Advanced making sessions beyond library capacity
- Student team skill development at makerspace

Our Community Value:

We bring:

- Established community partnerships (library, senior center)
- Focus on underserved populations (seniors, families)
- Student energy and youth perspective on making
- E-waste collection and device refurbishment expertise

Potential Partnership Models:

Option 1: Equipment Collaboration

- Technocopia donates decommissioned or surplus equipment
- We expand workshop capabilities at the library
- Recognize Technocopia as equipment partner

Option 2: Co-Hosted Programming

- Joint repair + making workshops
- Technocopia provides advanced equipment, we provide community outreach
- Shared visibility and community impact

Option 3: Student Membership/Access

- Discounted or sponsored membership for student team
- We develop advanced making skills
- We promote Technocopia to our community network

Community Benefit:

This partnership would:

- Expand maker education to underserved Shrewsbury populations
- Build connections between Worcester and Shrewsbury maker communities
- Support student-led STEM initiatives
- Promote sustainable making and Right to Repair

Our Student Team:

Five high school students with experience in:

- FRC robotics (programming, electrical, mechanical)

- Device repair and troubleshooting
- 3D printing and sustainable manufacturing
- Community education and outreach

Next Steps:

Would you be open to a visit and conversation about collaboration? I'd love to:

- Tour Technocopia and meet your team
- Discuss equipment needs and donation possibilities
- Explore co-hosted workshop opportunities
- Learn how student-led organizations can engage with makerspaces

We're available during your open hours (Mon-Fri, 9AM-2PM) and happy to schedule around your availability.

Thank you for building Worcester's maker community. We're excited about the possibility of connecting Shrewsbury students and residents to Technocopia's incredible resources.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Hanover Insurance Group Foundation

To: Contact through www.hanover.com/community-charitable-grant-program
Attn: Kimberly Salmon, Assistant Vice President, Community Relations
Subject: Community Grant Application - Tech Awareness Association Youth STEM Program

Dear Ms. Salmon and Hanover Insurance Group Foundation,

My name is Ronit Sharma, and I'm the Executive Director of Tech Awareness Association, a student-led organization providing free technology education in Shrewsbury and Worcester County.

I'm writing to apply for a Hanover Insurance Group Foundation community grant to support our youth-led STEM education and digital equity programming.

Tech Awareness Association teaches device repair, digital literacy, and environmental responsibility through monthly hands-on workshops at Shrewsbury Public Library, regular tech support visits at Southgate Senior Center, annual community e-waste collection drives, free repair education for underserved populations. The program is student-led and completely free to participants.

x

Alignment with Hanover Foundation Goals:

Our program supports:

- **Community Giving**: Free services to Shrewsbury/Worcester residents
- **Youth Leadership**: Student-led organization modeling civic engagement
- **Environmental Impact**: E-waste reduction and sustainable practices
- **Digital Equity**: Technology access for seniors and underserved families

Community Impact:

Through Hanover Foundation support, we would:

- Serve 100+ community members in Year 1
- Teach repair skills saving families hundreds of dollars
- Divert hundreds of pounds of e-waste from landfills
- Build digital literacy across generations
- Provide free tech support to seniors

Employee Volunteer Opportunities:

We welcome Hanover Insurance employees to:

- Volunteer at workshop events
- Share professional expertise (risk management, organizational best practices)
- Mentor student leadership team
- Participate in e-waste collection drives

Worcester Connection:

As a Worcester-based foundation, Hanover supports nonprofits serving Worcester County. Our programming serves:

- Shrewsbury residents (Worcester County)
- Potential expansion to Worcester city locations
- Regional e-waste reduction benefiting all of Worcester County

Partnership Recognition:

Hanover Foundation support would be recognized through:

- Logo on all workshop materials and website
- Social media acknowledgment and impact stories
- Partnership mention in grant applications
- Annual impact reports showing outcomes

Funding Priorities:

1. **Workshop Equipment ($1,500)**
    - Professional repair toolkits for participant use
    - Practice devices for educational demonstrations
    - Safety equipment and organizational supplies
2. **Curriculum Development ($500)**
    - Educational materials and visual aids
    - Senior-focused scam prevention resources
    - E-waste awareness and environmental content
3. **Community Outreach ($500)**
    - Workshop promotion materials
    - Event hosting supplies
    - Impact tracking and documentation tools
4. **Sustainable Operations ($500-$2,500)**
    - E-waste collection and recycling infrastructure
    - 3D printing materials for sustainable products
    - Program expansion to additional community sites

Next Steps:

Could you provide guidance on:

- Formal grant application process and timeline
- Specific documentation required for student-led organizations
- Opportunities for employee volunteering with our program
- Multi-year funding possibilities for program sustainability

Thank you for your commitment to Worcester County nonprofits. Your support would significantly expand our ability to serve underserved populations with hands-on STEM education.

Best regards,

Ronit Sharma
Executive Director, Tech Awareness Association
Email: contact@techawarenessma.com, rshar272k@gmail.com, tmangal@wpi.edu
Website: www.techawarenessma.com
Instagram: @techawarenessma
Phone: (617) - 206 - 7007

Ekansh Interview

Expanding into **Digital Heritage & Archiving** (which we could call **"The Legacy Project"**) transforms your association from "the people who fix tech" into "the people who save memories."

Because your team consists of tech-savvy students, you likely have the patience and the hardware access to bridge the gap between "shoeboxes of old photos" and "the cloud."

📂 The Legacy Project: A Roadmap

This initiative focuses on converting analog history into digital formats to ensure they aren't lost to time or physical degradation.

1. The "Mobile Digitization Lab"

Instead of a fixed location, create a portable kit that your team brings to the Shrewsbury Public Library or the Senior Center.

- **Photo & Slide Scanning:** High-speed scanners (like the Epson FastFoto) or even high-quality "Scan-to-PDF" mobile setups.
- **VHS-to-Digital:** A VCR connected to a USB video capture card ($20–$50) and a laptop. This is the "holy grail" for many families who haven't seen their wedding or home movies in 30 years.
- **Audio Cassette Conversion:** Small USB cassette players can convert old voice recordings or music tapes into MP3s.

2. "Memory Workshops"

Rather than doing all the work yourselves, host events where you **teach** residents how to use the equipment.

- **The Session:** Residents bring 10–20 items (photos or one tape). You set them up at a station, show them how to use the software, and they leave with a USB drive full of digital memories.
- **Cloud Onboarding:** Often, the "digital" part is the scariest for seniors. Your team can help them set up a Google Photos or iCloud account so their newly digitized photos are backed up and shareable with their grandkids immediately.

3. AI-Enhanced Restoration

Since your group is tech-forward, you can add a "High-Tech" layer to the archiving process:

- **Colorization & Sharpening:** Use AI tools (like Remini or MyHeritage's AI) to restore faded 1950s black-and-white photos to full color.
- **Noise Reduction:** For old audio tapes, use free software like **Audacity** to remove the "hiss" from a recording of a late relative's voice.

4. Collaboration with the Shrewsbury Historical Society

Partner with the local Historical Society to help them digitize their archives.

- **Public Access:** You could help them build a searchable digital database of old town maps, newspaper clippings, or local event photos that are currently sitting in physical folders.
- **Student Credits:** This is a perfect way for your members to earn formal community service hours through a registered non-profit partner.

🛡️ **Critical Considerations (The "Fine Print")**

- **Liability:** You must have a clear waiver stating that the association is not responsible for damage to old, fragile media (like a VHS tape snapping in the machine).
- **Privacy:** Establish a strict protocol. Volunteers should never keep copies of a resident's files. Once the transfer to the resident's USB is complete, the file must be wiped from the association's laptop.
- **Storage Costs:** Encourage residents to bring their own USB drives or external hard drives, or sell them at cost (around $10) as a small fundraiser for your club.

Why this works: It creates an emotional connection between the student and the resident. While an e-waste drive is a "transaction," digitizing a grandmother's wedding photo is an **experience**.

Gemini said

This expansion focuses on a **"Community Tech Triage"** model. Instead of just teaching people how to fix their own things (which takes time and specific tools many don't have), your association becomes a functional **pro-bono repair clinic.**

Here is how you can scale the "Intake & Repair" model into a professional, high-impact program at a new location like a **Local Sports Complex (e.g., Corazzini Field)** or a **Town Common Pop-up.**

🛠️ The Community Tech Triage Program

This model operates like a "Laptop Hospital." People drop off their sick tech, and your team of student experts performs the "surgery" in a controlled environment.

1. The "Mobile Intake" Station

Set up a tent or a table during high-traffic community events (like a Saturday morning soccer game or a town concert).

- **The Diagnostic Scan:** When someone brings a device, you perform an immediate 5-minute triage. Does it need a new battery? A screen? A factory reset?
- **The Liability Waiver:** This is crucial. Use a QR code that links to a digital form where the owner acknowledges that you are a student group and they are leaving the device at their own risk.
- **Tagging System:** Use "Toe Tags" (brightly colored zip-tie labels) to mark every device with the owner's name, contact info, and reported issue.

2. The "Repair Depot" (Back-End Operations)

Since you can't always fix a device on a folding table in a park, you move the hardware to your "Depot" (your home base or a dedicated workspace).

- **Parts Sourcing:** Create a "Parts Fund" from donations. If a senior's iPad needs a $20 battery, you use the fund to buy it, rather than making the senior navigate an electronics store.
- **The "Shadow" Repair:** Record your repairs! Set up a camera while you work. When you return the device, send the owner a 30-second "time-lapse" or a video of the fix. It builds incredible trust and shows the value of what you do.

3. Specialized "Repair Tracks"

Don't just fix "computers." Specialize in the things people usually throw away because they seem "too cheap to fix":

- **The Gaming Track:** Drift-fix for Joy-Cons or Xbox controllers. These are expensive to replace but often just need a $5 part or a cleaning.
- **The "Old Phone" Life-Extender:** Many people have an old iPhone 8 or X in a drawer with a cracked screen. Fix it so they can use it as a dedicated music player, a security camera, or a "starter phone" for their kid.
- **The Peripheral Clinic:** Fixing broken charging ports on headphones or loose hinges on laptops.

4. The "Fixed-it" Dashboard

Transparency is key for a student-led group.

- **Live Tracker:** On the `techawarenessma.com` site, have a "Current Patients" list (using only ticket numbers for privacy). People can check if their device is "In Surgery," "Testing," or "Ready for Pickup."
- **Impact Counter:** Track the "Market Value Saved." If you fix a $500 laptop with a $15 fan, add that $500 to a running total on your homepage. It's a powerful metric for future grants or donations.

5. The "Reverse E-Waste" Donation

Sometimes, a device is "totaled" (the motherboard is fried).

- **Harvesting:** Ask the owner if you can "harvest" the working parts (screens, buttons, screws, RAM) for the Parts Fund.
- **The Swap:** Offer them a refurbished device from your "Refurbished Pool" (items fixed from your e-waste drives) in exchange for their broken one. This keeps the resident connected and ensures the broken parts are properly recycled.

📋 What you need to launch this:

Resource	Purpose
iFixit Pro Toolkits	High-quality bits for every weird screw type.

Antistatic Mats	To ensure you don't fry a board while working in the field.
A "Parts Bin"	Organized storage for harvested screws, cables, and screens.
Ticketing Software	A simple Trello board or Google Sheet to track every device.

Pro Tip: Since you are in Shrewsbury, reaching out to the **Shrewsbury Town Manager's Office** for a "One-Day Permit" to set up a "Repair Booth" in front of the Town Hall is a great way to get official town backing without needing to be "at" the library.

Would you like me to draft a "Repair Log" template or a "Liability Waiver" that you can use for these walk-up repairs?

This plan, titled **"The Digital Shield,"** is designed for the Tech Awareness Association to teach residents how to identify AI-generated media. Since you are student experts, your role is to act as "Forensic Guides" for the community.

🛡️ Project: The Digital Shield

Format: 60-minute interactive workshop **Goal:** Empower residents to spot deepfake audio, images, and video using 2026-era detection techniques.

Part 1: The Visual "Forensics" (20 Minutes)

Teach the physical limitations of current AI models. Focus on things that are "computationally expensive" for AI to get right.

- **The "Six-Finger" & Beyond Rule:** Don't just look for extra fingers anymore (AI is getting better at that). Look for **jewelry that "merges" into skin**, earrings that don't match, or glasses that "melt" into the temples.
- **The Biological "Tell":** In videos, look for **unnatural blinking**. Real humans blink spontaneously; AI often blinks too rhythmically or not at all.
- **The "Turn Test":** Explain that many deepfakes are "front-facing." If you are on a video call and suspicious, ask the person to **turn their head 90 degrees** to the side. The AI "mask" often glitches or disappears at a full profile.

- **Lighting Physics:** AI often struggles with complex shadows. Look at the eyes—is the reflection of the room consistent with where the windows/lights are?

Part 2: The "Ear Test" & Voice Clones (15 Minutes)

This is the most critical section for seniors, as "Grandparent Scams" now use voice cloning.

- **The "Robotic Rhythm":** Cloned voices often lack **natural breathing patterns**. Listen for where the speaker takes a breath—if they speak a 30-word sentence without a "sniff" or pause, it's likely a clone.
- **Emotional Flatness:** AI can sound sad or happy, but it struggles with **"micro-inflections"**—the tiny cracks in a voice when someone is truly panicked.
- **The "Family Safe Word" Strategy:** Teach every resident to establish a "Safe Word" (e.g., "Lego Teapot") that is never posted online. If a "relative" calls in an emergency, they must provide the word. If they can't, hang up.

Part 3: The Verification Toolkit (15 Minutes)

Give them the actual tools to use at home.

- **Reverse Image Search (The Basics):** Teach them how to drag an image into **Google Lens** or **TinEye** to see if it appeared years ago in a different context.
- **C2PA & Content Credentials:** Explain the new "CR" (Content Authenticity) icon. Show them how to look for digital "nutrition labels" on images that prove they were taken by a real camera.
- **AI Detectors:** Introduce them to free consumer tools like **Deepware** or **Reality Defender (Lite)** where they can upload a suspicious video link to get a "Probability of AI" score.

Part 4: The "Real or Robot?" Quiz (10 Minutes)

Engagement is the best way to learn.

- **Live Game:** Show 10 images/videos on a screen. Have the audience vote "Real" or "AI" by raising their hands.
- **The Reveal:** After each vote, explain *why* it was fake (e.g., "Look at how the shadow of the coffee cup is pointing toward the sun—that's physically impossible").

🛠️ The "Take-Home" Kit

Give every attendee a 1-page **"Digital Defense Checklist"** they can stick on their fridge. It should include:

1. **Stop & Breathe:** If a piece of news makes you feel intense anger or fear instantly, it was designed to do that. Check the source.
2. **Verify the Source:** Did this come from a local Shrewsbury news outlet or a random account on X/Facebook?
3. **The "Hand & Head" Check:** Look for weird hands and ask for a head turn.
4. **Safe Word:** Did you ask for the family password?

How to Launch This:

- **Shrewsbury Public Library:** Perfect for a "Media Literacy Month" event.
- **Southgate Senior Center:** Focus heavily on the **Audio/Voice Clone** section and safe words.
- **Town Hall:** Pitch this as a "Public Safety Seminar" in collaboration with local law enforcement.

Would you like me to create the text for that "Digital Defense Checklist" handout so you can print it?

—----------

Senior Center Visits:

- If they want something repaired, fix it for next visit
- AI/fake media detection
- How to leverage AI

Past Plans

Past Plans

Progression Plan

Progression Plan

Here are the seven tasks made more descriptive and actionable for distribution to your colleagues, referencing the roles and programs outlined in your "Tech Awareness Association" document.Detailed Task Descriptions for Colleagues

1. Create Tech Awareness Association Instagram Account

- **Goal:** Establish the club's official presence on Instagram to document events, share impact, and attract student volunteers/community members.
- **Steps:**
    - Set up a new Instagram profile using the club's official name ("Tech Awareness Association").
    - Complete the profile bio, incorporating the 1-sentence mission statement from your document.
    - Link to your simple website/Google Site (once created).
    - Configure settings to ensure a professional, public profile.
    - (Initial setup to be completed before handing off to the Content Creation task.)
- **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lead

2. Develop "Why Tech Awareness Matters" Educational Slideshows

- **Goal:** Create engaging, short slideshows (5-8 slides) that can be used at the beginning of library workshops to explain the club's "What We Believe In" section.
- **Steps:**
    - Develop a module focusing on **Fighting E-Waste** (using data points like "toxic chemicals in landfills" from the document).
    - Develop a module focusing on **Understanding Your Device** (addressing the "technology shouldn't be a mystery" vision).
    - Use compelling images and simple language.
- **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead

3. Create Core Content for Instagram & Establish Following Strategy

- **Goal:** Generate initial, high-quality content and build a relevant audience for the new Instagram page.
- **Steps:**
    - Create **5 high-impact posts** to launch the page (e.g., a "Meet the Team" post, a post explaining the E-Waste Drive, a post showing a successful repair).
    - Develop a template for "Post-Workshop Recap" content.
    - Identify and follow key local partners (Shrewsbury Public Library, Southgate Senior Center, local news/community pages, iFixit).
- **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lead

4. Design Official Tech Awareness Association Logo

- **Goal:** Create a simple, professional logo and style guide to be used on the website, social media, and flyers to build credibility.
- **Steps:**
    - Draft 3-5 simple, distinct logo concepts (e.g., using a gear, a recycling symbol, or a wrench with text).
    - Select one final design and create versions for all necessary formats (e.g., square for social profile, horizontal for website banner).
    - Document the club's official brand colors and font (if applicable).
- **Best Fit:** Executive Director or Outreach & Community Lead (Collaborative)

5. Develop "How to Avoid Scams" Slideshow for Seniors

- **Goal:** Create a vital educational resource for the Southgate Senior Center visits, focusing on common online threats.
- **Steps:**
    - Research and compile the **Top 5 Common Tech Scams** (e.g., phishing emails, tech support scams, grandkid scams).
    - Create a simple, large-text slideshow that clearly explains *what* the scam is and *how to respond* (e.g., "Hang up," "Don't click," "Call a family member").
    - Review the presentation with the Programs Lead to ensure the tone is patient and non-judgmental.
- **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead

6. Draft Formal Partnership Email to Shrewsbury Public Library

- **Goal:** Write a professional email to the library to formalize your request for recurring monthly workshop dates and potentially request confirmation letters for grant applications.
- **Steps:**
    - Draft a formal email to the contact at the **Shrewsbury Public Library Foundation** or **Friends of the Shrewsbury Public Library** (as referenced in your Sponsors section).
    - Reiterate the value the club provides to the community (hands-on skills, tech support).
    - Propose the specific, recurring dates you require.
    - Request an official statement of partnership for use in grant applications.
- **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lead

7. Create Detailed Lesson Plans for Teaching Seniors

- **Goal:** Standardize the curriculum for the weekly/regular senior center visits to ensure quality and consistency across volunteers.
- **Steps:**

    - Develop **3 core lesson plans** based on common needs (e.g., "Setting up a New App," "Video Calling Family," "Managing Phone Storage/Photos").
    - The plan should include a simple, step-by-step volunteer guide that emphasizes the "patient support" and "teaching, not fixing" philosophy.
    - Include a short post-session feedback form to track the most requested topics.
- **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead

PHASE 1: Lock the Foundation (Next 1–2 Weeks)

1. Clarify Your Core Focus (Do this first)

Decide your **top 3 priorities** (everything else is optional later). For example:

- Device repair education
- Senior tech support
- E-waste reduction

Write a **1-sentence mission** you can repeat everywhere:

> “We teach people how to repair their devices, reduce e-waste, and confidently use technology through hands-on, community-based programs.”

This prevents scope creep.

---

2. Define 3 Flagship Programs

Pick **exactly 3 programs** to run consistently:

- Monthly library repair workshops
- Senior center tech support visits
- Annual e-waste drive

Document for each:

- Who it’s for
- How often it runs
- What success looks like

This makes you look legitimate to partners and funders.

---

3. Formalize Roles (Even if it’s just friends)

Assign **clear responsibilities**:

- Program Lead (events & workshops)
- Operations Lead (tools, devices, logistics)
- Outreach Lead (partners, marketing)
- Finance Lead (fundraising, sales, tracking funds)

Even if one person has 2 roles, **write them down**.

PHASE 2: Build Capacity (Next 1 Month)

4. Standardize Everything

Create **repeatable systems**:

- Workshop checklist (tools, devices, guides)
- Repair intake form (what device, issue, outcome)
- Volunteer training doc (safety, teaching style)
- E-waste sorting process

This is how small clubs become scalable organizations.

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5. Build a Device & Tool Inventory

You need:

- Basic phone/laptop toolkits
- Donated devices for practice
- Storage system (bins + labels)

Track:

- What you have
- What works
- What's missing

This makes grant applications MUCH easier later.

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6. Create Simple Training

Before expanding:

- Teach members basic phone + laptop repair
- Practice explaining repairs to non-technical people
- Emphasize **teaching, not fixing for them**

If someone can't explain it clearly, they don't run the station.

PHASE 3: Visibility & Credibility (Month 2–3)

7. Document Impact Early

Start tracking:

- **of people helped**
- **of devices repaired**
- Pounds of e-waste collected
- Estimated cost saved

Put this in a **living Google doc or spreadsheet**.

Impact data = power.

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8. Build a Simple Online Presence

You don't need fancy:

- One website page or Google Site
- Clear description of programs
- Contact info
- Photos from workshops

This helps parents, libraries, and sponsors trust you.

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9. Deepen Partnerships (Not More of Them)

Strengthen existing ones:

- Ask library for recurring dates
- Ask senior center for a regular schedule
- Ask recyclers for official confirmation letters

Consistency > expansion.

PHASE 4: Funding & Growth (Month 3–6)

10. Stabilize Funding

Short-term:

- E-waste resale
- 3D-printed accessories
- Small donations at events

Mid-term:

- Local business sponsorships
- Environmental or STEM grants

Have a **1-page budget** ready.

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11. Pilot ONE New Program

Only add **one**:

- Laptop refurbish & donate
- Tech Buddy program
- Youth summer repair camp

Run it once → evaluate → repeat or drop.

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12. Leadership Continuity Plan

Very important for student groups:

- Document how programs run
- Train younger students

- Create a “handoff” guide

This keeps the org alive after you graduate.

PHASE 5: Long-Term Expansion (Optional, 1+ Year)

- Help another town copy your model
- Build a mobile repair setup
- Advocate formally for Right to Repair
- Create a student repair certification

KEY RULE TO REMEMBER

Do fewer things, consistently, with quality.
That’s how this turns from a club into a respected community organization.

If you want, next I can:

- Turn this into a **timeline checklist**
- Help you write a **1-page action plan**
- Prepare a **grant-ready version**
- Design a **first 30-day execution plan**

Just tell me which one you want.

Non Chat/Ideas

Non Chat/Ideas

- Runs monthly hands-on device repair workshops at the Shrewsbury Public Library
- Teaches participants how to replace batteries, fix screens, and troubleshoot phones and laptops using iFixit guides
- Hosts device tear-down sessions so people can learn how technology works internally
- Provides one-on-one tech help for seniors and families (phones, apps, online safety, setup)
- Organizes an annual community e-waste drive to collect and responsibly recycle old electronics
- Reuses collected devices for education, repair practice, or fundraising
- Partners with certified recycling facilities to keep hazardous materials out of landfills
- Hosts community repair events where people learn to fix their own broken devices
- Provides regular tech support visits to the Southgate Senior Center
- Runs repair-themed escape rooms that teach problem-solving and technical skills
- Uses 3D printers with recycled filament to create phone cases and accessories
- Raises funds through e-waste recycling and sustainable product sales
- Collaborates with libraries, senior centers, and local organizations
- Promotes Right to Repair awareness and sustainable technology practices
- Repair vs Replace Cost Calculator
- Weekly email blog(Using Claude of Course)

Trash Tech Art Show

Ideas:

- Summer program teaching kids how to repair tech
- Right to Repair Advocacy
- Go to senior centers and help them with technology
- Post informatics

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeYhF8lhMWdK1LiAkZ6z2PAgnBHHyIRa9b3qaXvjh4fVapW0A/viewform
https://macir.org/digitalaccesscenter/
https://www.thetechfoundry.org/tech-hub/springfield

2026 Ideas:

-Seminars at middle schools/elementary schools
- Proper use of AI/ AI Energy concerns

2025 Tasks

Tasks

- [x] ~~**1. Create Tech Awareness Association Instagram Account(Ronit/Nathan)[12-24-25]**~~
    - **Goal:** Establish the club's official presence on Instagram to document events, share impact, and attract student volunteers/community members.
    - **Steps:**
        - Set up a new Instagram profile using the club's official name ("Tech Awareness Association").
        - Complete the profile bio, incorporating the 1-sentence mission statement from your document.
        - Link to your simple website/Google Site (once created).
        - Configure settings to ensure a professional, public profile.
        - (Initial setup to be completed before handing off to the Content Creation task.)
    - **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lea
- [ ] **2. Develop "Why Tech Awareness Matters" Educational Slideshows(Puneeth)[01-03-26]**
    - **Goal:** Create engaging, short slideshows (5-8 slides) that can be used at the beginning of library workshops to explain the club's "What We Believe In" section.
    - **Steps:**
        - Develop a module focusing on **Fighting E-Waste** (using data points like "toxic chemicals in landfills" from the document).
        - Develop a module focusing on **Understanding Your Device** (addressing the "technology shouldn't be a mystery" vision).
        - Use compelling images and simple language.
    - **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead
- [ ] **3. Create Core Content for Instagram & Establish Following Strategy(Puneeth)[01-03-26]**
    - **Goal:** Generate initial, high-quality content and build a relevant audience for the new Instagram page.
    - **Steps:**
        - Create **5 high-impact posts** to launch the page (e.g., a "Meet the Team" post, a post explaining the E-Waste Drive, a post showing a successful repair).
        - Develop a template for "Post-Workshop Recap" content.
        - Identify and follow key local partners (Shrewsbury Public Library, Southgate Senior Center, local news/community pages, iFixit).
    - **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lead
- [x] ~~**4. Design Official Tech Awareness Association Logo(Ronit/Tanay)[12-28-25]**~~
    - **Goal:** Create a simple, professional logo and style guide to be used on the website, social media, and flyers to build credibility.
    - **Steps:**

        - Draft 3-5 simple, distinct logo concepts (e.g., using a gear, a recycling symbol, or a wrench with text).
        - Select one final design and create versions for all necessary formats (e.g., square for social profile, horizontal for website banner).
        - Document the club's official brand colors and font (if applicable).
    - **Best Fit:** Executive Director or Outreach & Community Lead (Collaborative)

☐ **5. Develop "How to Avoid Scams" Slideshow for Seniors(Suhaas)[01-03-26]**

- **Goal:** Create a vital educational resource for the Southgate Senior Center visits, focusing on common online threats.
- **Steps:**
    - Research and compile the **Top 5 Common Tech Scams** (e.g., phishing emails, tech support scams, grandkid scams).
    - Create a simple, large-text slideshow that clearly explains *what* the scam is and *how to respond* (e.g., "Hang up," "Don't click," "Call a family member").
    - Review the presentation with the Programs Lead to ensure the tone is patient and non-judgmental.
- **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead

☑ ~~**6. Draft Formal Partnership Email to Shrewsbury Public Library(Tanay)[12-28-25]**~~

- **Goal:** Write a professional email to the library to formalize your request for recurring monthly workshop dates and potentially request confirmation letters for grant applications.
- **Steps:**
    - Draft a formal email to the contact at the **Shrewsbury Public Library Foundation** or **Friends of the Shrewsbury Public Library** (as referenced in your Sponsors section).
    - Reiterate the value the club provides to the community (hands-on skills, tech support).
    - Propose the specific, recurring dates you require.
    - Request an official statement of partnership for use in grant applications.
- **Best Fit:** Outreach & Community Lead

☐ **7. Create Detailed Lesson Plans for Teaching Seniors(Nathan/Suhaas)[01-03-26]**

- **Goal:** Standardize the curriculum for the weekly/regular senior center visits to ensure quality and consistency across volunteers.
- **Steps:**
    - Develop **3 core lesson plans** based on common needs (e.g., "Setting up a New App," "Video Calling Family," "Managing Phone Storage/Photos").
    - The plan should include a simple, step-by-step volunteer guide that emphasizes the "patient support" and "teaching, not fixing" philosophy.
    - Include a short post-session feedback form to track the most requested topics.
- **Best Fit:** Programs & Education Lead

To-Do List/Progress Checklist

To-Do List/Progress Checklist

🧱 FOUNDATION (Weeks 1–2)

- ⬜ Finalize 1-sentence mission statement
- ⬜ Select **3 core programs** (no more, no less)
- ⬜ Write short descriptions for each core program
- ⬜ Assign leadership roles (Program, Ops, Outreach, Finance)
- ⬜ Create shared drive (Google Drive) for all documents

🛠️ OPERATIONS SETUP (Weeks 2–4)

- ⬜ Create workshop checklist (tools, devices, guides)
- ⬜ Create device intake & repair tracking form
- ⬜ Write volunteer training & safety guide
- ⬜ Build toolkits (phone + laptop basics)
- ⬜ Organize device storage (labeled bins)
- ⬜ Establish e-waste sorting & recycling process

📚 TRAINING & QUALITY (Weeks 3–5)

- ⬜ Train members on basic phone repairs
- ⬜ Train members on basic laptop repairs
- ⬜ Practice explaining repairs to non-technical users
- ⬜ Establish “teach, don’t fix-for” rule
- ⬜ Set safety & liability guidelines

📊 IMPACT TRACKING (Ongoing)

- ⬜ Track # of people helped
- ⬜ Track # of devices repaired
- ⬜ Track pounds of e-waste collected
- ⬜ Track funds raised & used
- ⬜ Take photos (with permission) for documentation

🌐 VISIBILITY & CREDIBILITY (Month 2)

- ⬜ Create simple website or Google Site
- ⬜ Add mission, programs, contact info
- ⬜ Publish workshop schedule
- ⬜ Collect partner confirmation statements
- ⬜ Create basic logo/branding

🤝 PARTNERSHIPS (Month 2–3)

- ⬜ Lock recurring library workshop dates
- ⬜ Lock recurring senior center visits
- ⬜ Confirm certified recycling partners
- ⬜ Identify 3–5 potential sponsors
- ⬜ Prepare sponsor outreach email

💰 FUNDING (Month 3–6)

- ⬜ Create 1-page budget
- ⬜ Track income from e-waste resale
- ⬜ Track income from 3D-printed items
- ⬜ Open organization bank/treasury system (if applicable)
- ⬜ Research grants (STEM/environment/youth)

🚀 GROWTH & PILOTS (Month 4–6)

- ⬜ Choose **ONE** pilot expansion program
- ⬜ Plan pilot timeline & materials
- ⬜ Run pilot once
- ⬜ Evaluate results
- ⬜ Decide to repeat, expand, or drop

🔄 CONTINUITY & HANDOFF (Critical)

- ⬜ Document how each program runs
- ⬜ Train at least 2 younger members per role
- ⬜ Create leadership handoff guide
- ⬜ Archive key docs & contacts

🧠 OPTIONAL ADVANCED GOALS

- ⬜ Right to Repair advocacy event
- ⬜ Summer youth repair program
- ⬜ Laptop donation program
- ⬜ Mobile repair setup
- ⬜ Town-to-town replication plan

🔑 RULE TO FOLLOW

If it’s not on the checklist, **don’t add it yet**.

If you want, I can:

- Turn this into a **30-day sprint checklist**
- Convert it into a **Notion or Trello board structure**
- Create a **grant-ready impact checklist**
- Help you prioritize what to do **this week**

Just tell me what you want next.

Official Tasks By Person

Official Tasks By Person

RONIT SHARMA (Executive Director)

Foundation & Leadership *(Deadline: 12/31/25)*

- ☐ Finalize 1-sentence mission statement *(12/27/25)*
- ☐ Define top 3 core priorities (device repair, senior support, e-waste) *(12/27/25)*
- ☐ Select exactly 3 flagship programs *(12/28/25)*
- ☐ Document all assigned leadership roles *(12/28/25)*

Branding & Online Presence *(Deadline: 01/15/26)*

- ☐ Co-create Instagram account with Nathan *(12/26/25)*
- ☐ Design official logo with Tanay - create 3-5 concept drafts *(12/28/25)*
- ☐ Finalize logo + create style guide with Tanay (brand colors, fonts, formats) *(12/30/25)*
- ☐ Create simple website or Google Site with mission, programs, contact info *(01/15/26)*

Partnerships *(Deadline: 01/20/26)*

- ☐ Send finalized library partnership email *(01/02/26)*
- ☐ Confirm recurring monthly workshop dates with library *(01/10/26)*
- ☐ Request official partnership confirmation letter from library for grants *(01/10/26)*
- ☐ Contact Southgate Senior Center to lock in regular visit schedule *(01/05/26)*
- ☐ Request partnership confirmation letter from senior center *(01/10/26)*

Event Execution *(Deadline: 02/28/26)*

- ☐ Oversee all library workshop execution *(target: late January 2026)*
- ☐ Coordinate first senior center visit *(target: early February 2026)*

Long-Term Sustainability *(Deadline: 03/31/26)*

- ☐ Document how each program runs (standard operating procedures) *(02/15/26)*
- ☐ Train at least 2 younger members per leadership role *(03/01/26)*
- ☐ Create leadership handoff guide *(03/15/26)*
- ☐ Finalize next-phase roadmap (pilot expansion ideas) *(03/31/26)*

TANAY MANGAL (Programs & Education Lead)

Branding *(Deadline: 12/30/25)*

- [ ] Design official logo with Ronit - create 3-5 concept drafts *(12/28/25)*
- [ ] Finalize logo + create style guide with Ronit (brand colors, fonts, formats) *(12/30/25)*

Curriculum Development *(Deadline: 02/25/26)*

- [x] ~~Outline full 12-week library curriculum *(12/30/25)*~~
- [ ] Review all educational slides for tone & clarity *(01/05/26)*
- [ ] Complete Week 1 library workshop slideshow *(01/15/26)*
- [ ] Complete Week 2 library workshop slideshow *(01/25/26)*
- [ ] Complete Week 3 library workshop slideshow *(02/05/26)*
- [ ] Complete Week 4 library workshop slideshow *(02/15/26)*
- [ ] Complete Week 5 library workshop slideshow *(02/25/26)*

~~**Partnership Communications *(Deadline: 12/28/25)***~~

- [x] ~~Draft formal partnership email to Shrewsbury Public Library Foundation *(12/28/25)*~~

Training & Standards *(Deadline: 01/22/26)*

- [x] ~~Write volunteer teaching guide emphasizing "teach, don't fix-for" philosophy *(01/10/26)*~~
- [ ] Lead team practice session on explaining repairs to non-technical users *(01/22/26)*

Event Execution *(Deadline: 02/28/26)*

- [ ] Lead educational awareness segment at first library workshop *(workshop date)*

NATHAN ANWIN (Operations & Logistics Lead)

~~**Online Presence *(Deadline: 12/26/25)***~~

- [x] ~~Co-create Instagram account with Ronit *(12/26/25)*~~

Senior Support Materials *(Deadline: 01/10/26)*

- [ ] Create 3 detailed senior lesson plans with Suhaas (Setting up Apps, Video Calling, Managing Storage) *(01/10/26)*
- [ ] Include post-session feedback form in lesson plans *(01/10/26)*

Workshop Systems *(Deadline: 01/10/26)*

- [ ] Create workshop checklist (tools, devices, iFixit guides) *(01/05/26)*
- [ ] Create device intake & repair tracking form *(01/08/26)*
- [ ] Write safety procedures & liability guidelines *(01/10/26)*
- [ ] Match tools/devices to lesson needs for each curriculum week *(01/10/26)*

Inventory & Equipment *(Deadline: 01/25/26)*

- [ ] Build basic phone + laptop repair toolkits *(01/15/26)*
- [ ] Inventory all tools & donated devices *(01/20/26)*
- [ ] Organize device storage system (labeled bins) *(01/20/26)*
- [ ] Establish e-waste sorting & recycling process *(01/25/26)*

Recycling Partnerships *(Deadline: 01/20/26)*

- [ ] Identify and contact 3 certified e-waste recycling facilities *(01/08/26)*
- [ ] Obtain official confirmation letters from recyclers *(01/20/26)*
- [ ]

Event Execution & Impact Tracking *(Ongoing from 01/25/26)*

- [ ] Manage tools, devices, and safety at first library workshop *(workshop date)*
- [ ] Prep accessibility tools for first senior center visit *(1 week before visit)*
- [ ] Track devices repaired & e-waste diverted *(ongoing starting 01/25/26)*

Ekansh Jain (Outreach & Community Lead)

Content Infrastructure *(Deadline: 12/30/25)*

- [ ] Set up content folder + posting templates *(12/28/25)*

- [ ] Prepare Instagram launch visuals *(12/30/25)*

Educational Materials *(Deadline: 01/03/26)*

- [ ] Create "Why Tech Awareness Matters" slideshow - Fighting E-Waste module *(01/03/26)*
- [ ] Create "Understanding Your Device" slideshow module *(01/03/26)*

Social Media Launch *(Deadline: 01/10/26)*

- [ ] Create 5 high-impact Instagram launch posts (Meet the Team, E-Waste Drive, successful repair, etc.) *(01/03/26)*
- [ ] Launch Instagram page publicly *(01/05/26)*
- [ ] Follow key partners (library, senior center, iFixit, local orgs) *(01/05/26)*
- [ ] Create workshop recap post template *(01/10/26)*

Ongoing Content *(Ongoing from mid-January)*

- [ ] Post "Preparing for First Workshop" content *(mid-January)*
- [ ] Take photos at events (with permission) for documentation *(ongoing)*
- [ ] Post workshop recap after first library workshop *(within 2 days of workshop)*
- [ ] Post senior-support story after first senior center visit *(within 2 days)*
- [ ] Post "Impact So Far" summary *(end of February)*
- [ ] Schedule future social media posts (1 month ahead) *(ongoing)*

SUHAAS GOLUGURI (Finance & Impact Lead)

Foundation Infrastructure *(Deadline: 12/27/25)*

- [x] ~~Create master task tracker + budget spreadsheet *(12/27/25)*~~
- [x] ~~Set up shared Google Drive for all documents *(12/27/25)*~~

Senior Support Materials *(Deadline: 01/10/26)*

- [ ] Create "How to Avoid Scams" slideshow for seniors (Top 5 scams, large text, patient tone) *(01/03/26)*
- [ ] Create 3 detailed senior lesson plans with Nathan (Setting up Apps, Video Calling, Managing Storage) *(01/10/26)*
- [ ] Include post-session feedback form in lesson plans *(01/10/26)*

Sponsor Research & Outreach *(Deadline: 02/15/26)*

- ☐ Research and list 20+ potential sponsors with contact info *(01/03/26)*
- ☐ Contact iFixit education program (education@ifixit.com) *(01/05/26)*
- ☐ Draft sponsor outreach email template *(01/08/26)*
- ☐ Research Best Buy Community Grants 2026 timeline *(01/10/26)*
- ☐ Personalize emails for top 10 sponsors *(01/10/26)*
- ☐ Send sponsor emails (round 1) + log responses *(01/15/26)*
- ☐ Apply for micro-grants *(01/31/26)*
- ☐ Send sponsor impact update after first events *(within 1 week of events)*
- ☐ Send sponsor thank-you messages *(after receiving funding)*

Financial Management *(Deadline: 01/15/26)*

- ☐ Create 1-page budget document *(01/08/26)*
- ☐ Set up income tracking for e-waste resale *(01/15/26)*
- ☐ Set up income tracking for 3D-printed items *(01/15/26)*
- ☐ Update funding tracker weekly *(ongoing)*

Impact Tracking *(Ongoing from 01/20/26)*

- ☐ Create impact tracking system (# people helped, devices repaired, e-waste collected) *(01/20/26)*
- ☐ Log attendance, costs, impact for each workshop *(ongoing)*
- ☐ Compile monthly impact report *(last day of each month)*
- ☐ Compile comprehensive sponsor report + budget forecast *(03/31/26)*

FUTURE CONSIDERATIONS (ALL TEAM) *(Post-March 2026)*

- Choose ONE pilot expansion program (summer youth repair, laptop donation, mobile setup)
- Host annual e-waste drive
- Run repair-themed escape room event
- Launch "Trash Tech Art Show"
- Develop Right to Repair advocacy campaign
- Create repair vs. replace cost calculator tool
- Establish weekly email blog